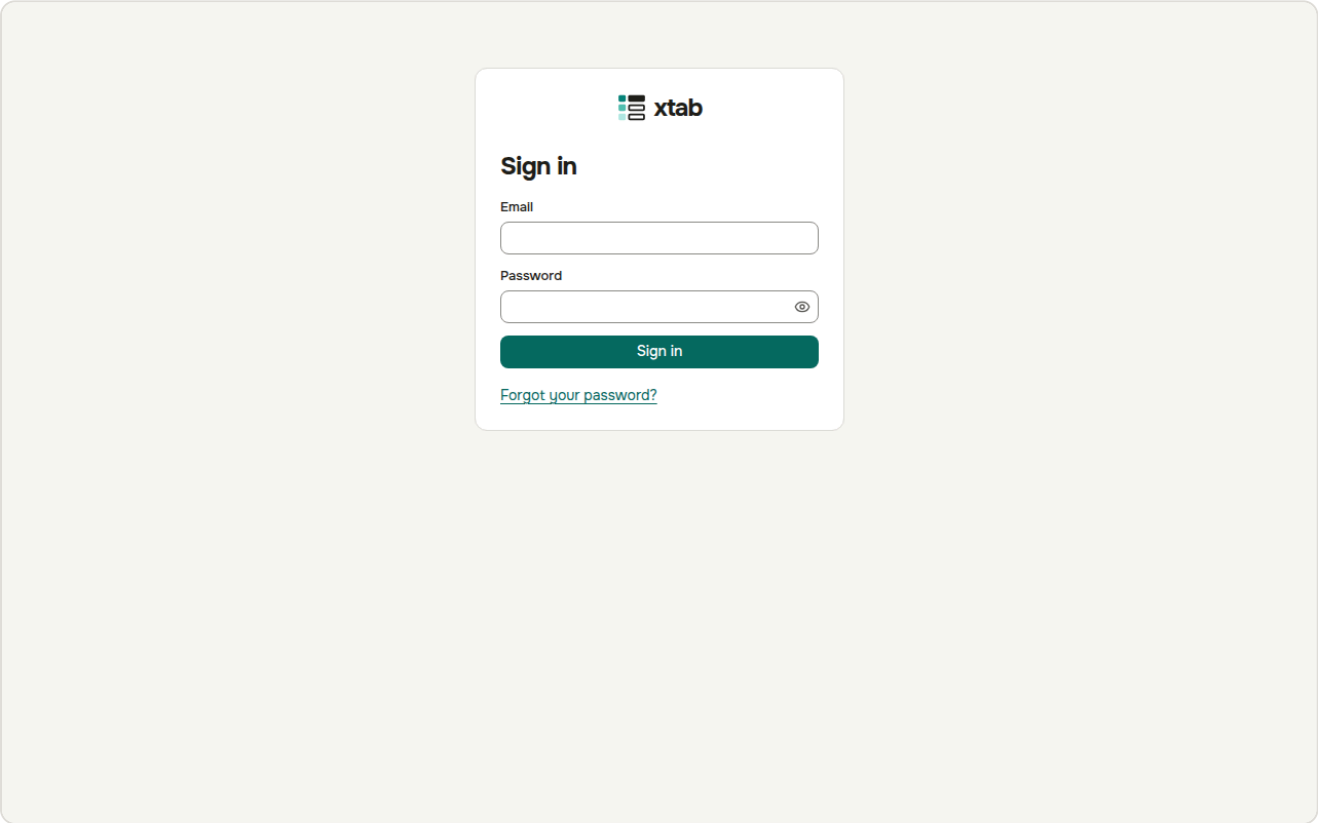
xtab user guide

How to work with xtab: sign in, set up a workspace, a base and tables, enter records, set up fields and views, search, and move data from spreadsheets and back. The guide describes version 0.3 and grows with every release.

Signing in

Your first letter from xtab is an invitation with a link. Open the link, enter your name, make up a password of at least 12 characters and click **Join**. The link works once.

Next time, open the address of xtab, enter your e-mail and password and click **Sign in**. To check that you typed the password correctly, click the eye icon on the right of the password field — the password becomes visible; click it again to hide it.



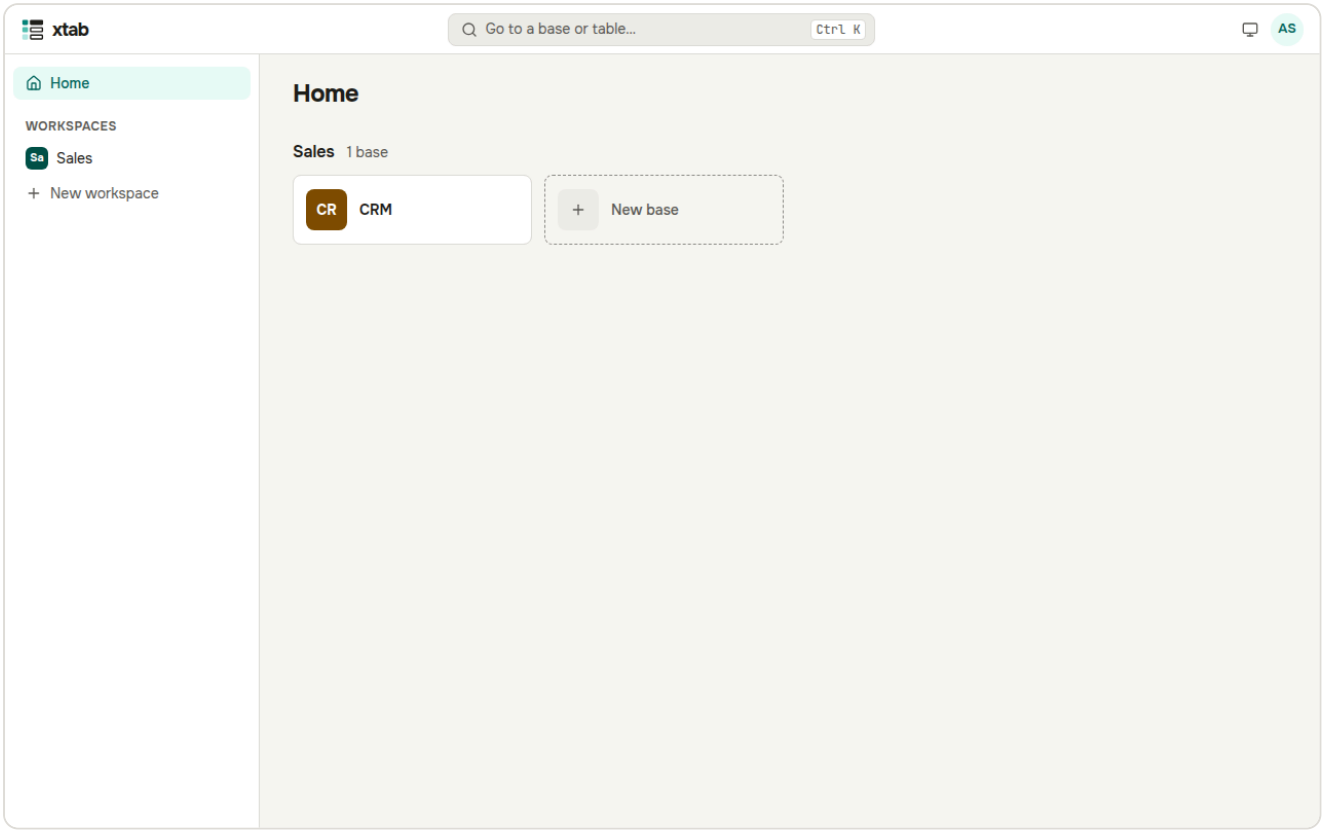
The sign-in page

If you forgot your password, click **Forgot your password?**, enter your e-mail and click **Send a link**. Set a new password by the link in the letter.

To sign out, click the circle with your initials in the top right corner and choose **Sign out**.

Home: workspaces and bases

After you sign in, the home page opens. On the left are the workspaces: each gathers the bases of one department or line of work. On the right are the bases of each workspace as tiles.



Home with a workspace and a base

- **New workspace:** on the left, click **New workspace**, enter a name and press Enter.
- **New base:** in the workspace you need, click the tile **New base**, enter a name and press Enter. The base opens right away.
- **Open a base:** click its tile.
- **Go to a workspace:** click it in the list on the left.

Base and tables

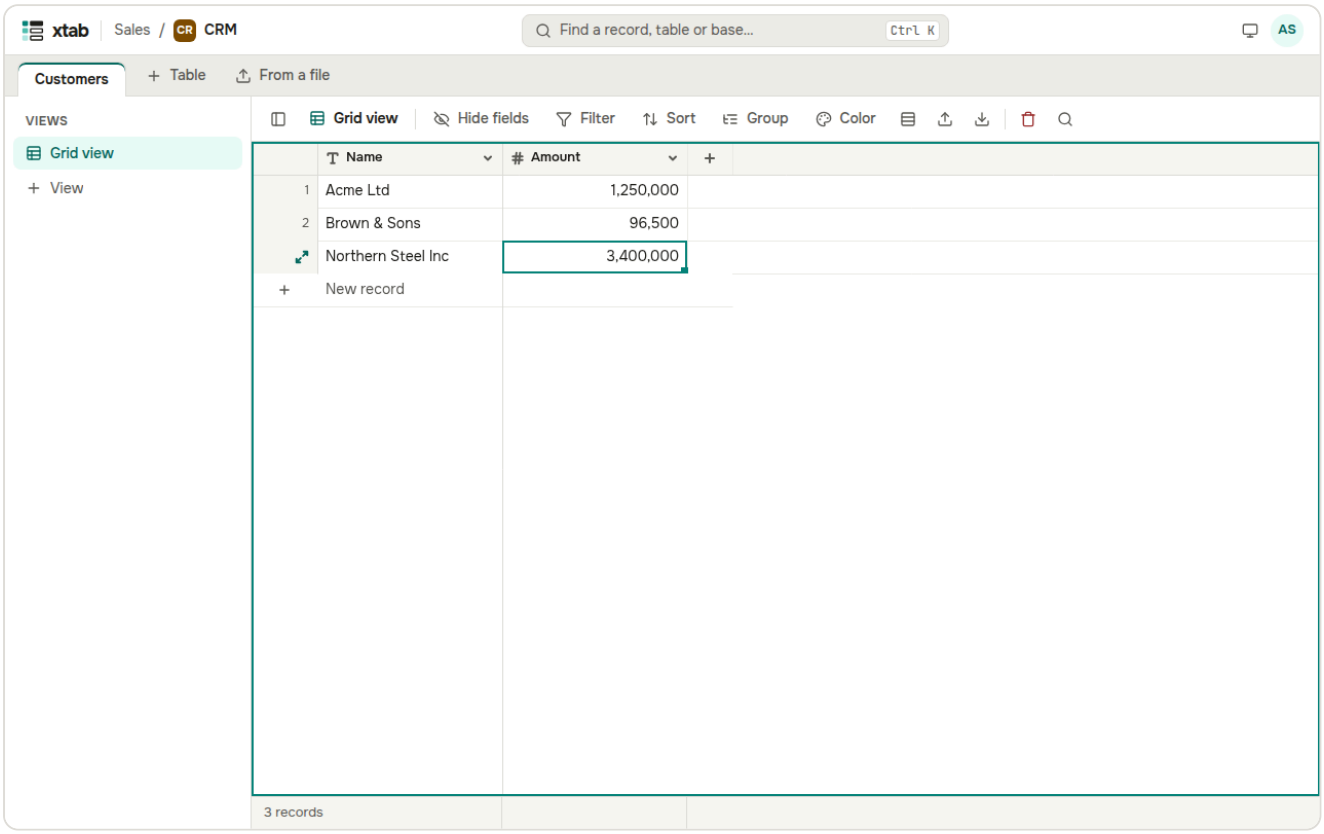
The tables of a base are the tabs under the top bar. The first table opens.

- **New table:** click **+ Table** to the right of the tabs, enter a name and press Enter. A new table already has the field «Name».
- **A table from a CSV or Excel file:** click **From a file** to the right of the tabs — see «Import from CSV and Excel».
- **Another table:** click its tab.

The top bar shows which workspace and base you are in. To go back home, click the xtab logo on the left.

Records in a table

A table shows records as rows and fields as columns. The first column is the primary field of a record: it stays in place when the table scrolls to the right. The number of records in the view is shown at the bottom.



A table with records

- **Select a cell:** click it. Move between cells with the arrows, Tab, Page Up and Page Down, Home and End.
- **Change a value:** press Enter or double-click the cell, or just start typing. Enter or Tab save the value, Esc cancels the edit. Numbers can be typed with commas: `1,250,000.50`.
- **Checkbox:** press Enter or click the selected cell again.
- **Clear a cell:** press Delete.
- **New record:** click the row **New record** under the last record.
- **New record below the selected one:** press Shift+Enter.
- **Delete a record:** select any of its cells, click the bin above the table and confirm.

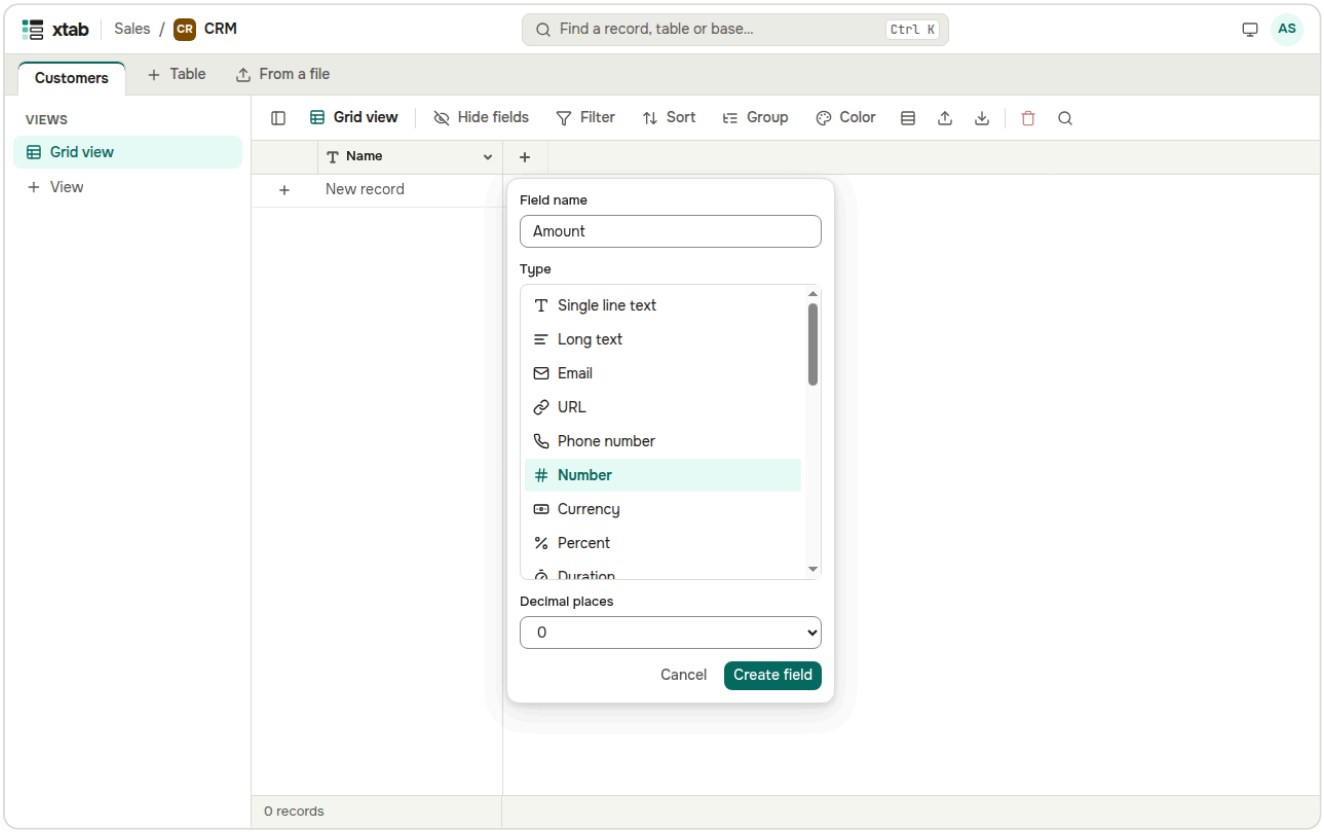
Fields the system fills (created time, created by, autonumber) cannot be changed.

Fields

Every field has a type, and its icon is shown in the column header.

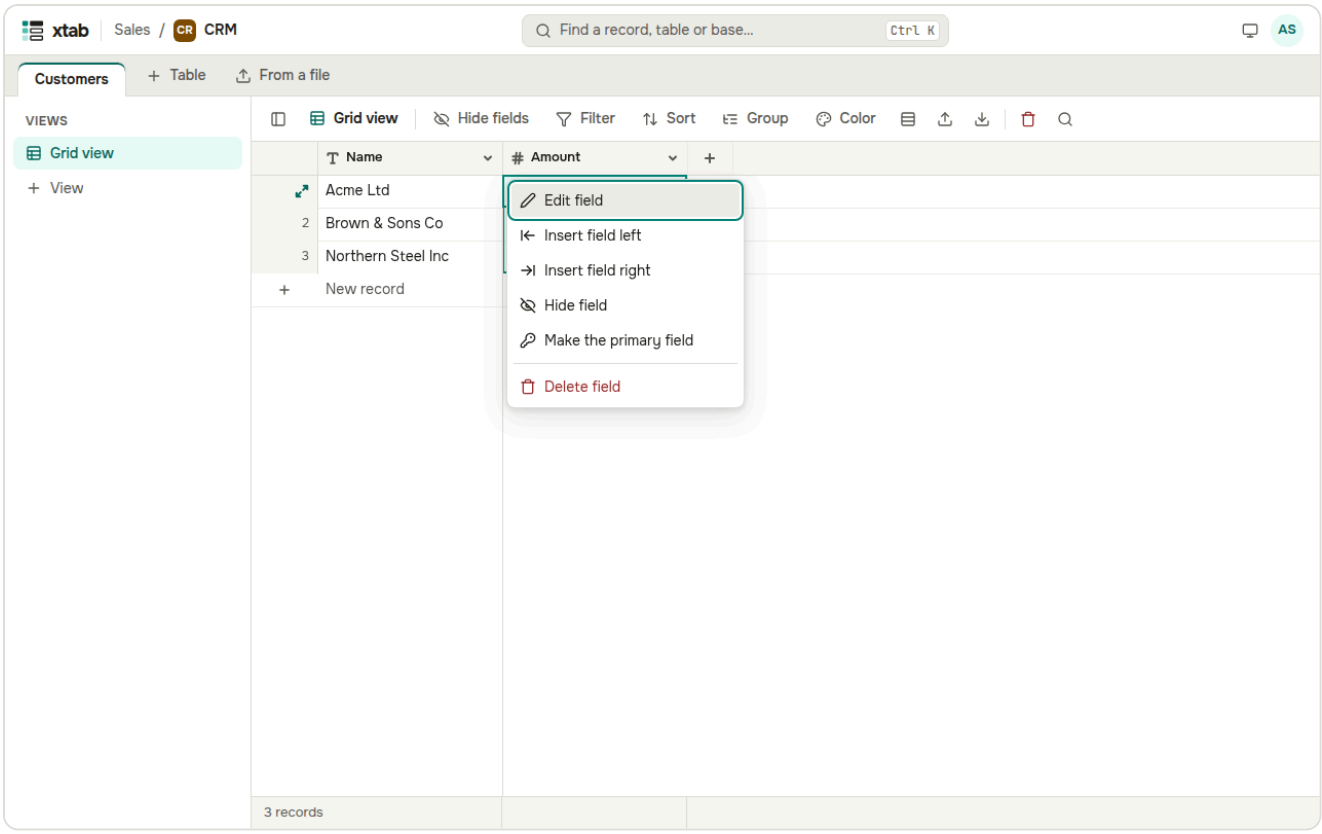
- **Text and contacts:** single line text, long text, email, URL, phone number.
- **Numbers:** number, currency, percent, duration, rating.
- **Choices:** checkbox, single select, multiple select, user.
- **Dates:** date, date and time.
- **Links between tables:** link, lookup, count, rollup.
- **Calculations:** formula.
- **Files:** attachments.
- **Filled in by the system:** autonumber, created or last modified time, created or last modified by.

A new field at the end of the table: click **+** to the right of the last column, enter a name, choose a type and click **Create field**.



A new field

The menu of a field: click the header of its column.

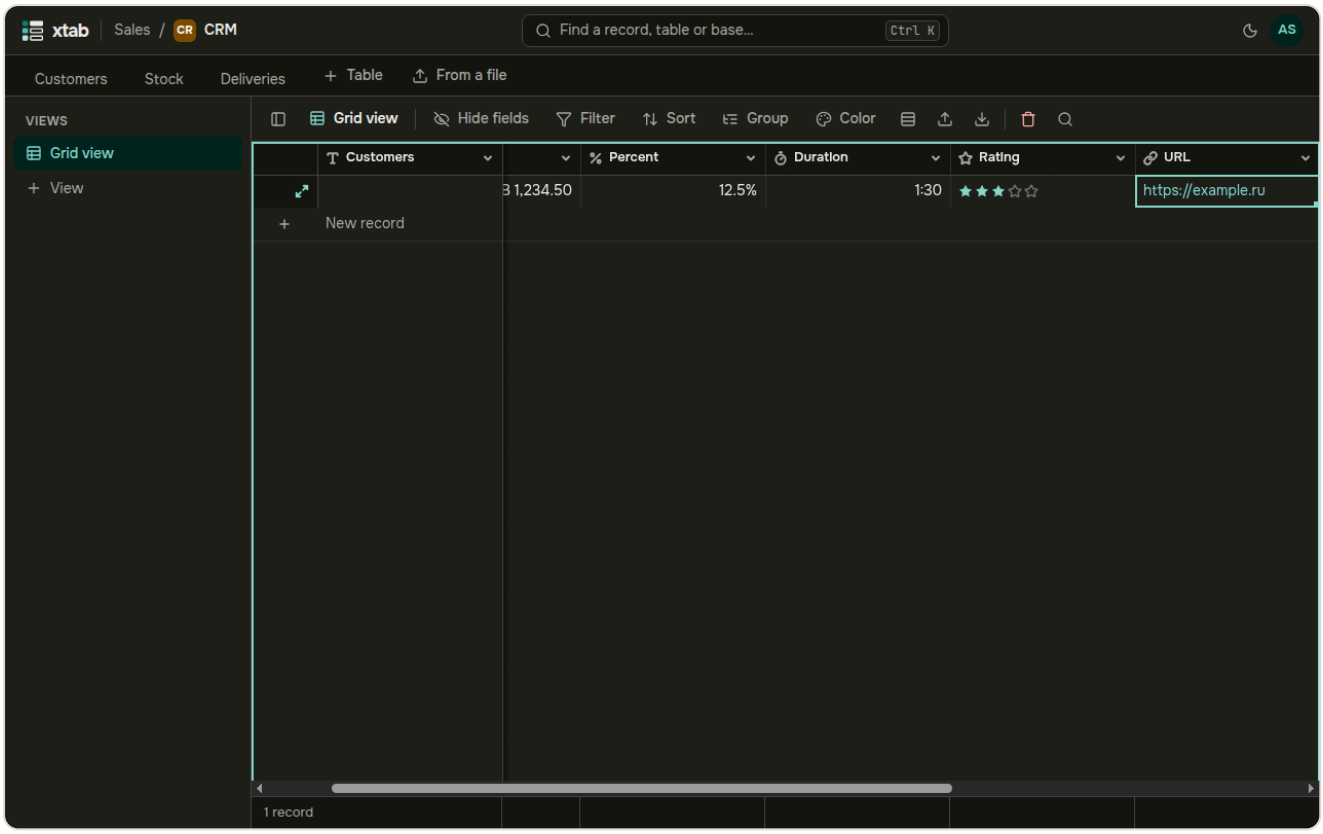


The menu of a field

- **Edit field** — a new name, the options of a list (one per line), the number of decimal places, or the text of a formula.
- **Insert field left** or **right** — a new field next to this one.
- **Make the primary field** — the field becomes the first column and the name of the record: its value is what links, the quick switcher and the record title show. A formula can be the primary field too.
- **Hide field** — the column disappears from this view; the data stays.
- **Delete field** — the field is deleted with all its values after you confirm. The primary field cannot be deleted.

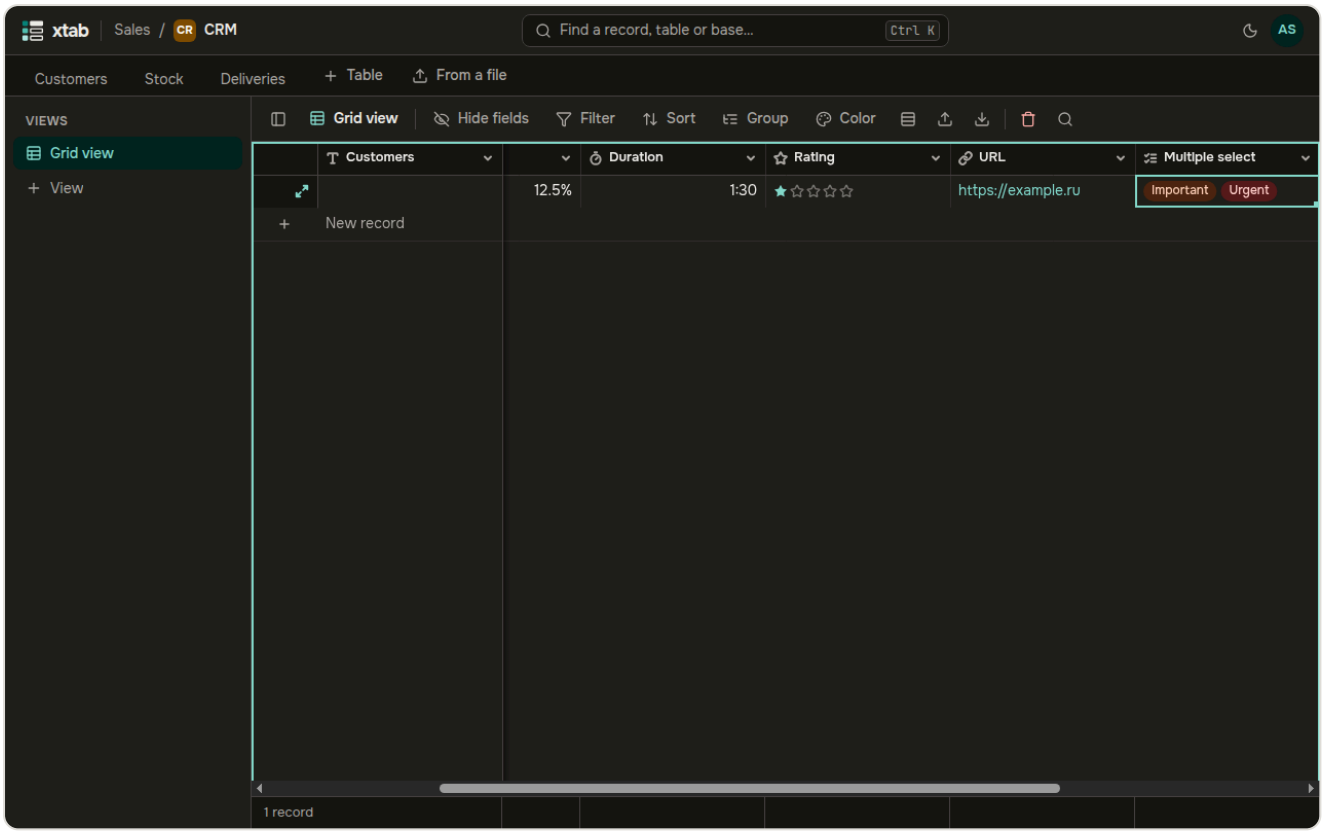
Values of different field types

- **Currency, percent, duration:** type the way you are used to: `1,234.50`, `12.5`, `1:30`. xtab adds the currency sign, the percent sign and the hours and minutes.
- **Rating:** click the star you want.
- **Email and URL:** the address becomes a link.



Currency, percent, duration, rating and URL

- **Multiple select:** select the cell and press Enter, then tick the options. They appear in the cell in the order you ticked them.
- **User:** press Enter, start typing a member's name and pick them from the list. The field setting **Several people in a cell** allows more than one person.



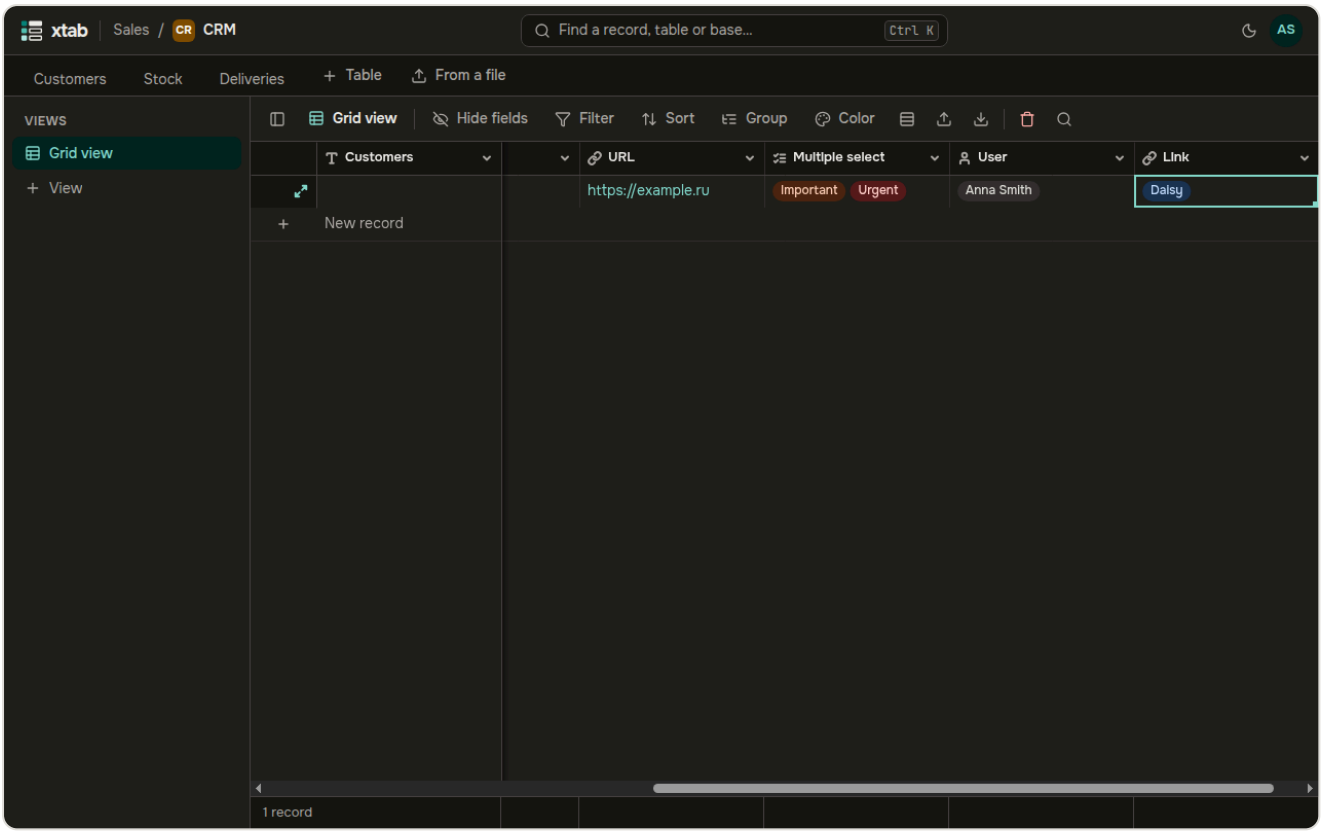
Multiple select and user

Links between tables

A **Link** field connects a record with records of another table: for example, a customer with their suppliers.

Create a link: add a field of type **Link** and choose the **Linked table**. Turn on **One record only** if a cell should hold a single record. The linked table gets a field back, so the link is visible from both sides.

Link records: select the cell and press Enter, find a record by its name and pick it from the list. The cross on a pill removes the link.



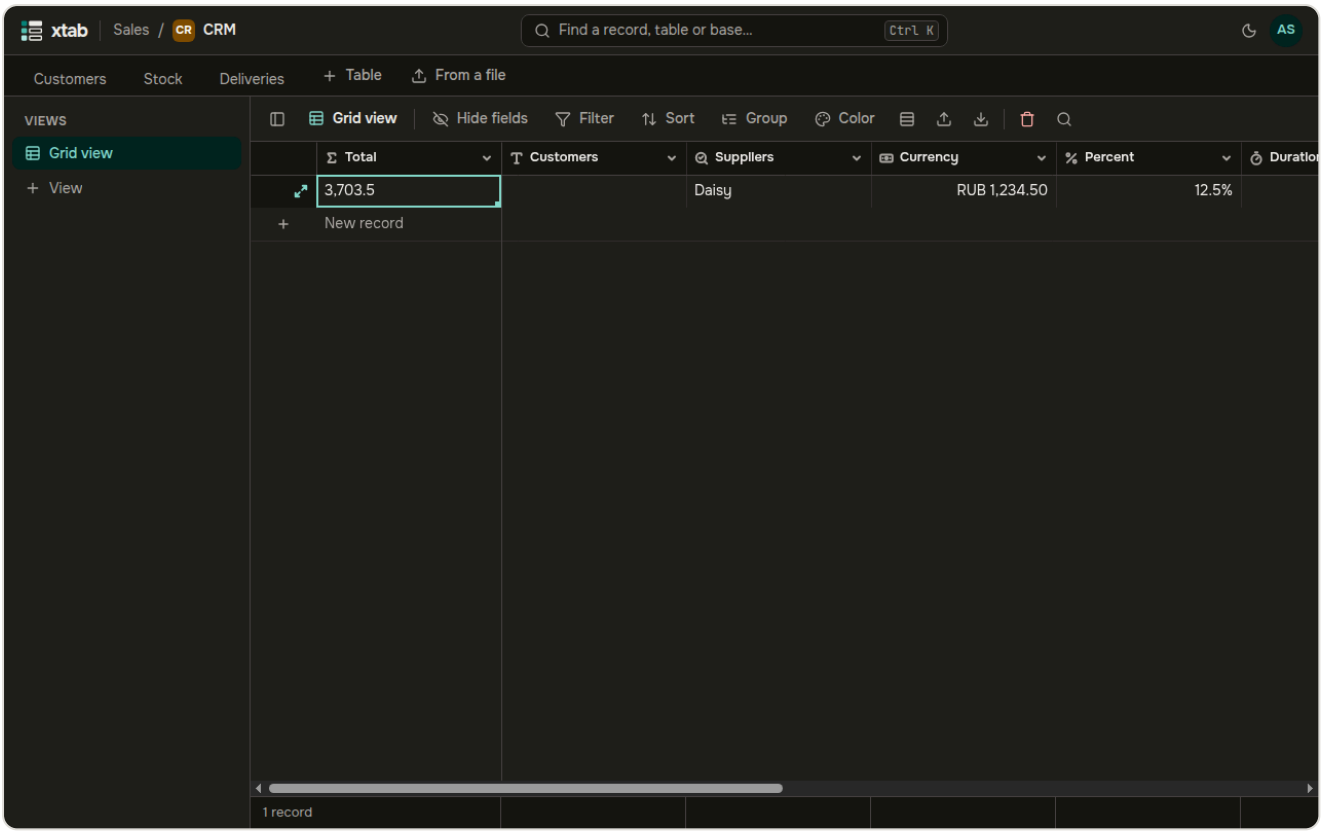
A link to a record of another table

- Links can be pasted from the clipboard as the names of the linked records.
- Records can be filtered, sorted and grouped by a link — by the names of the linked records.
- An export writes the names of the linked records.

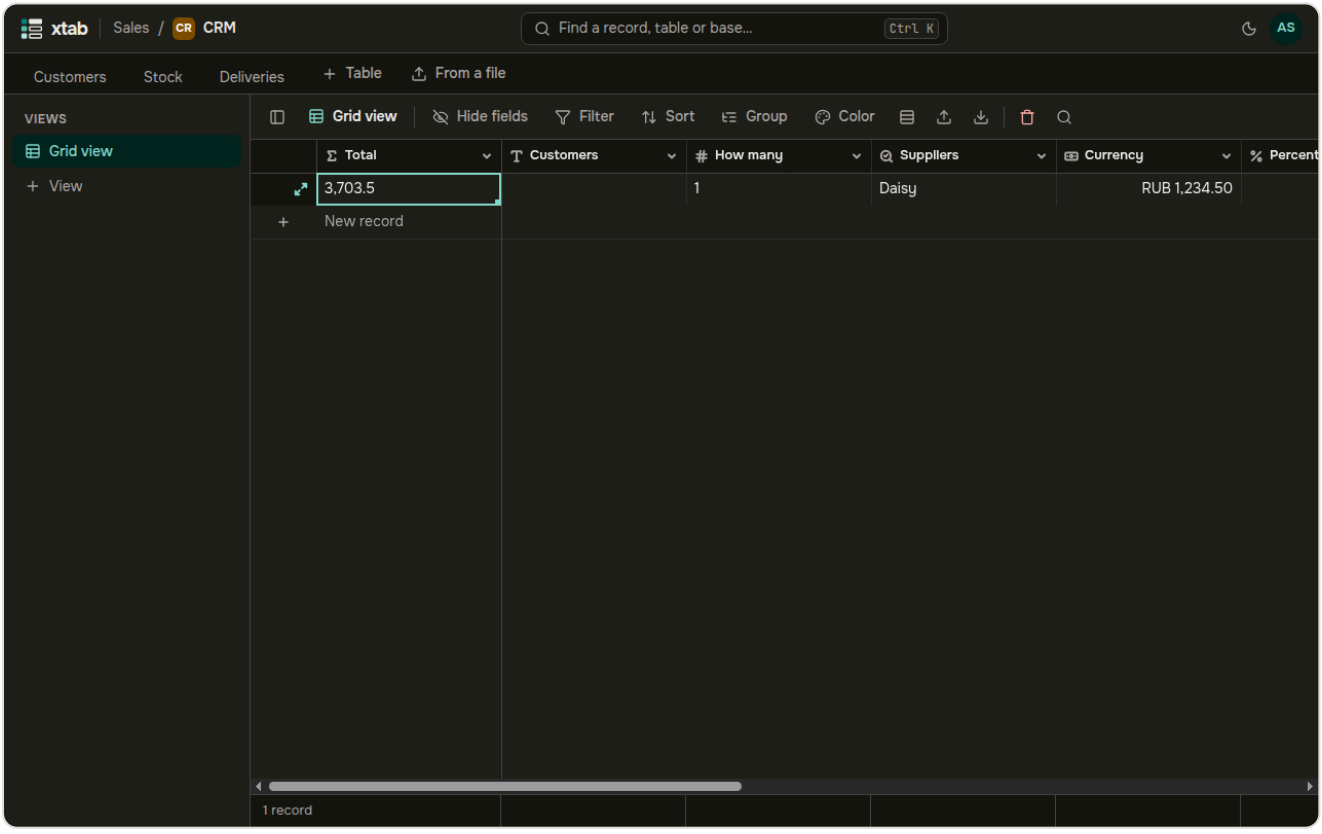
Lookup, count and rollup

These fields take data from linked records and update themselves when the linked records change.

- **Lookup** shows the values of a chosen field of the linked records, such as the cities of the suppliers. In the field form choose the **Link field** and the **Field of the linked table**.
- **Count** counts the linked records. Choose the **Link field**.



A lookup of supplier names

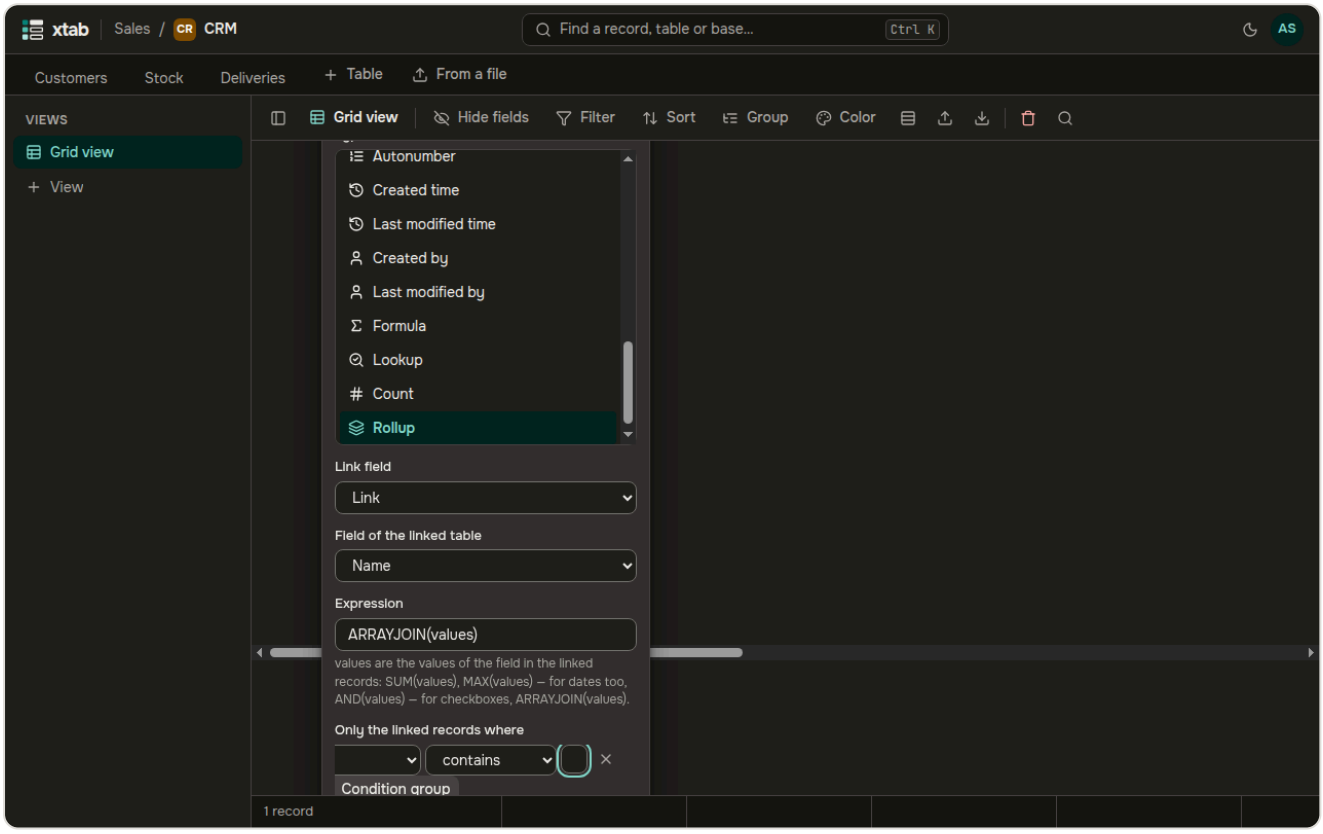


The count of linked records

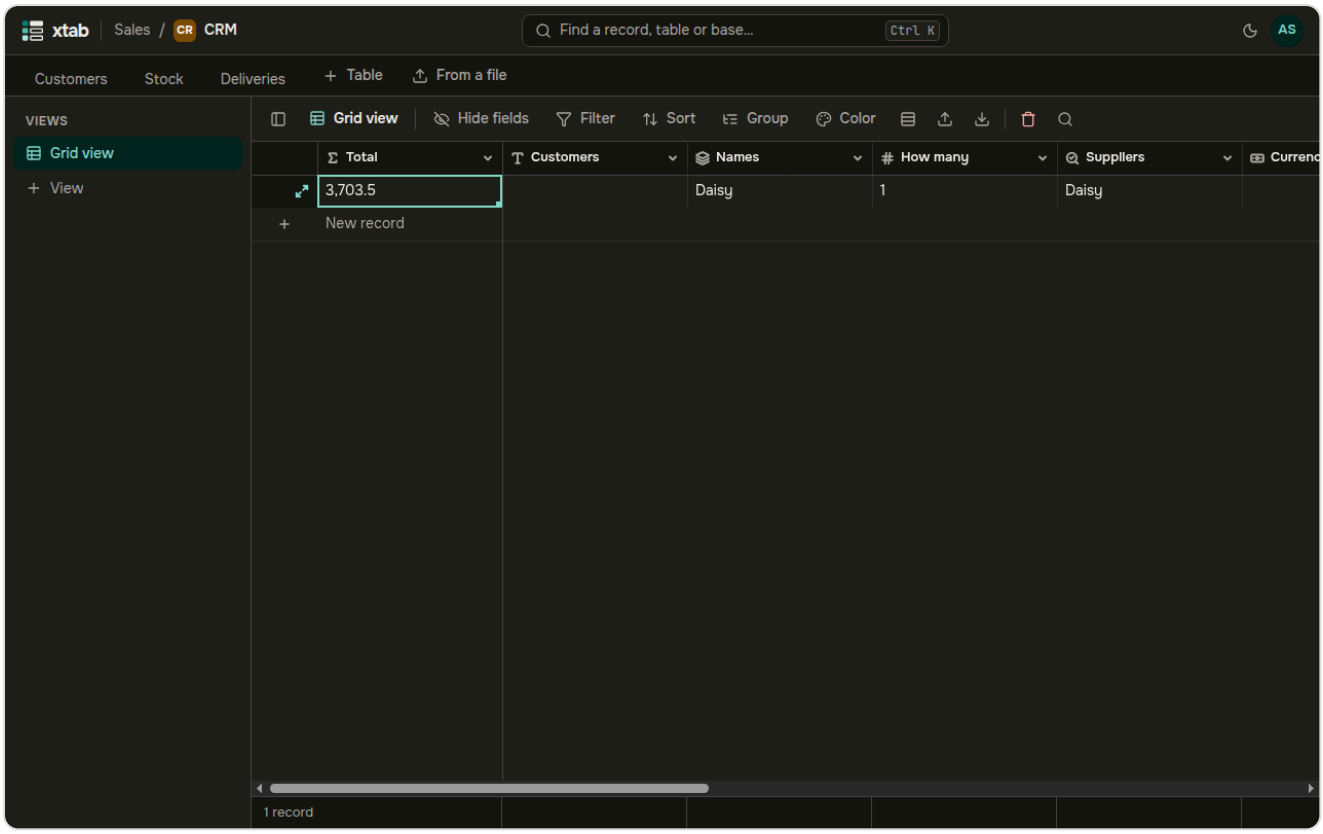
- **Rollup** computes one value over the linked records. Choose the **Link field** and the **Field of the linked table**, then enter an **Expression**. `values` in it stands for the values of the field in the linked records:

- `SUM(values)` — the sum;
- `MAX(values)` — the largest value, dates included;
- `AND(values)` — for checkboxes;
- `ARRAYJOIN(values)` — all values separated by commas.

Only the linked records where limits the rollup to the matching records; its conditions work the same way as in a filter.



The form of a rollup

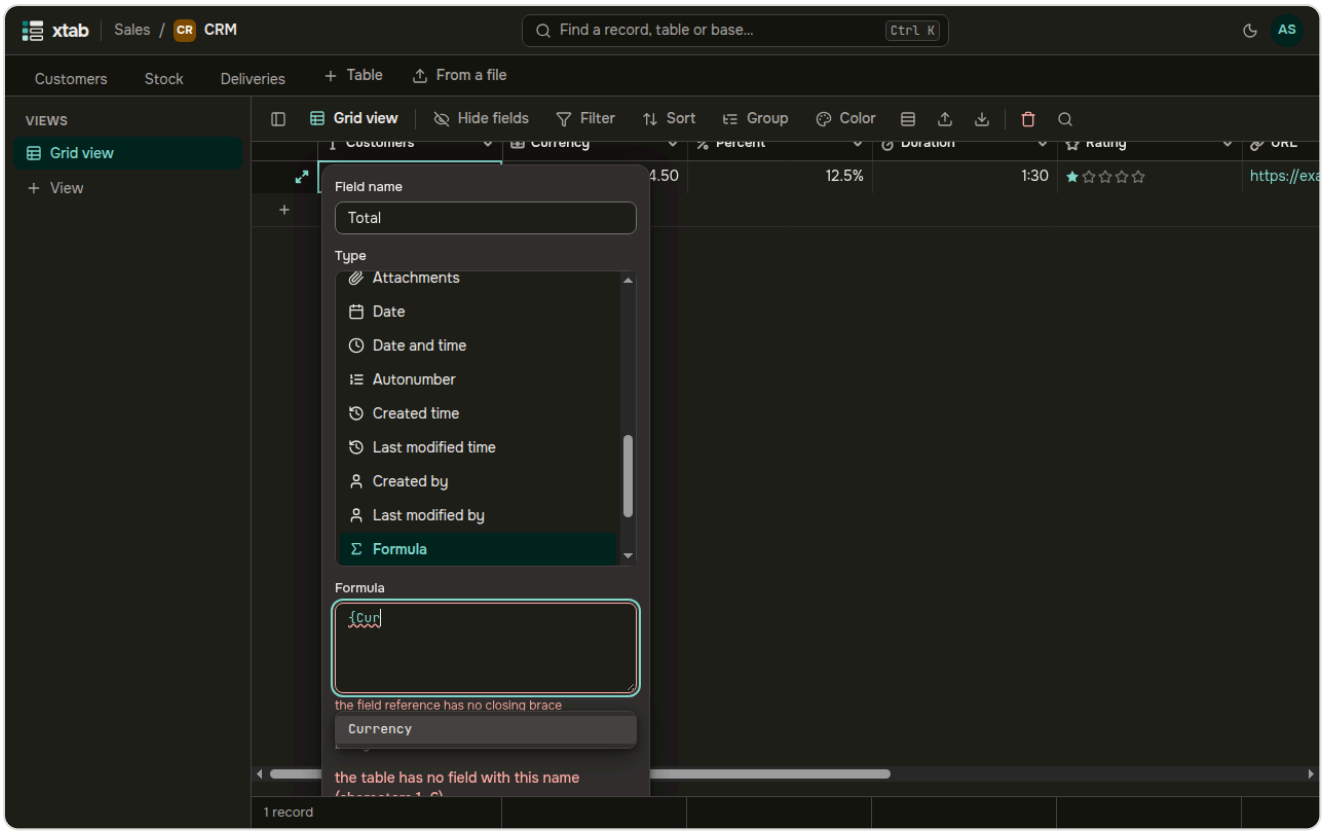


A rollup in the table

Formulas

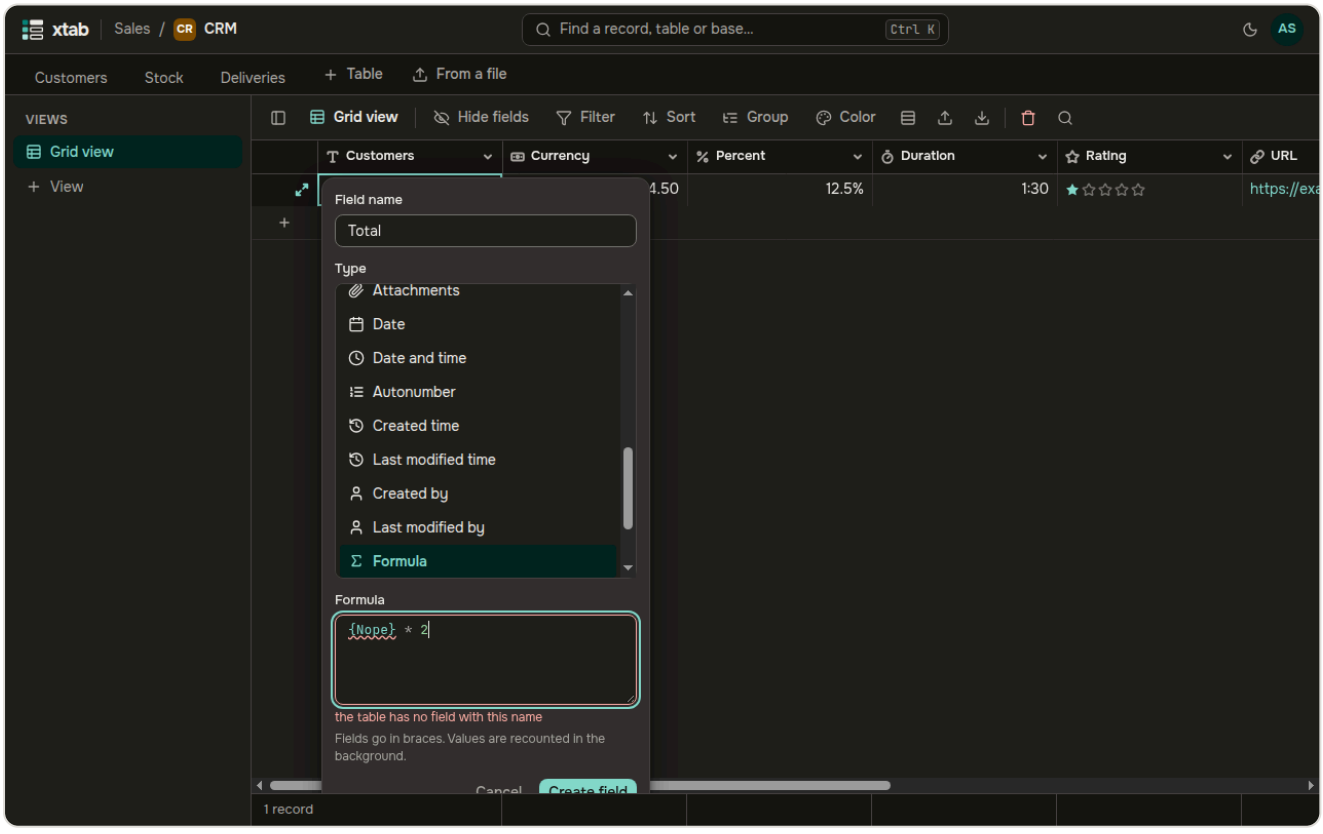
A **Formula** field computes a value from other fields of the record, for example `{Price} * {Quantity}`.

1. Add a field of type **Formula** and type the formula. Field names go in braces.
2. After `{` xtab offers the fields, and as you start typing a function name it offers the functions. Choose one with the arrow keys and press Enter.



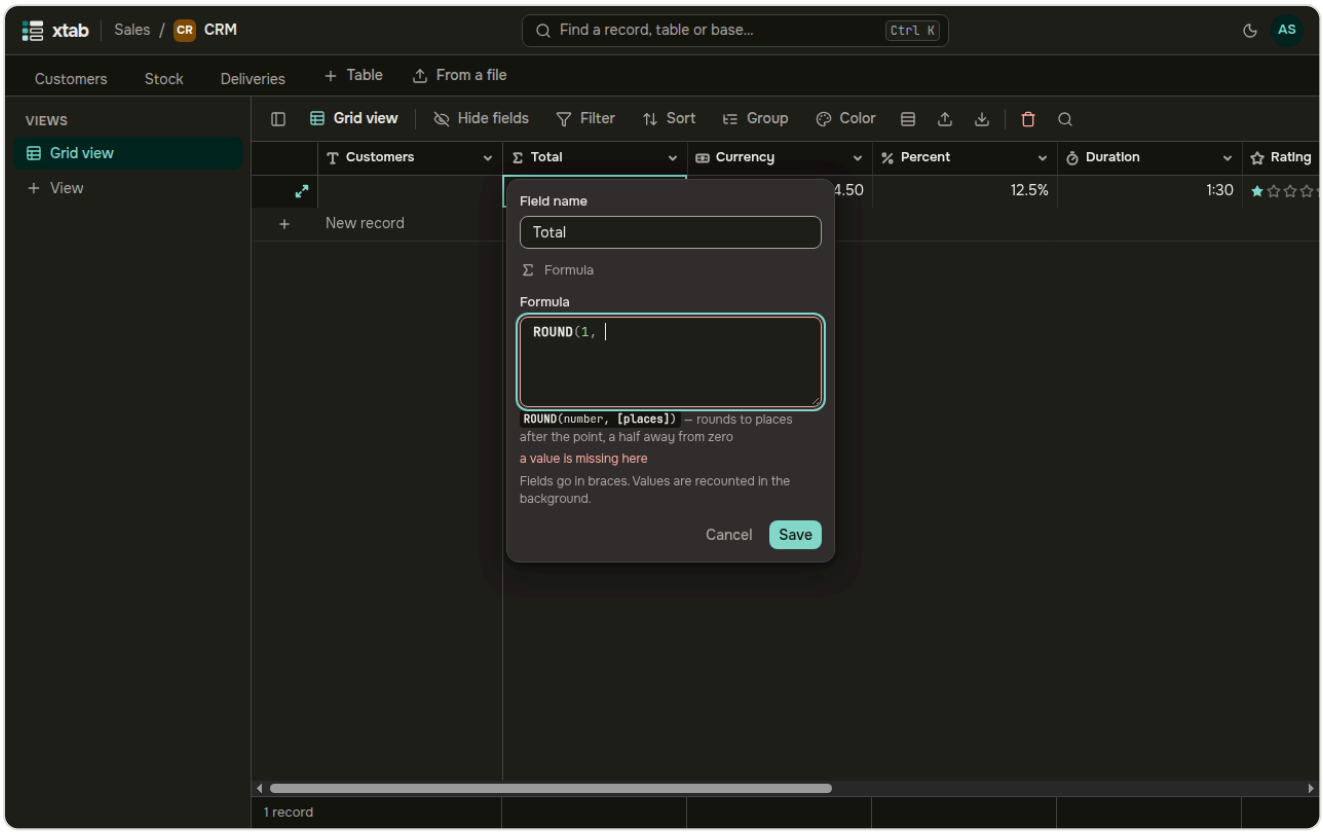
Field suggestions while typing a formula

1. A mistake is underlined at once, and the text below the formula says what is wrong.



A mistake in a formula

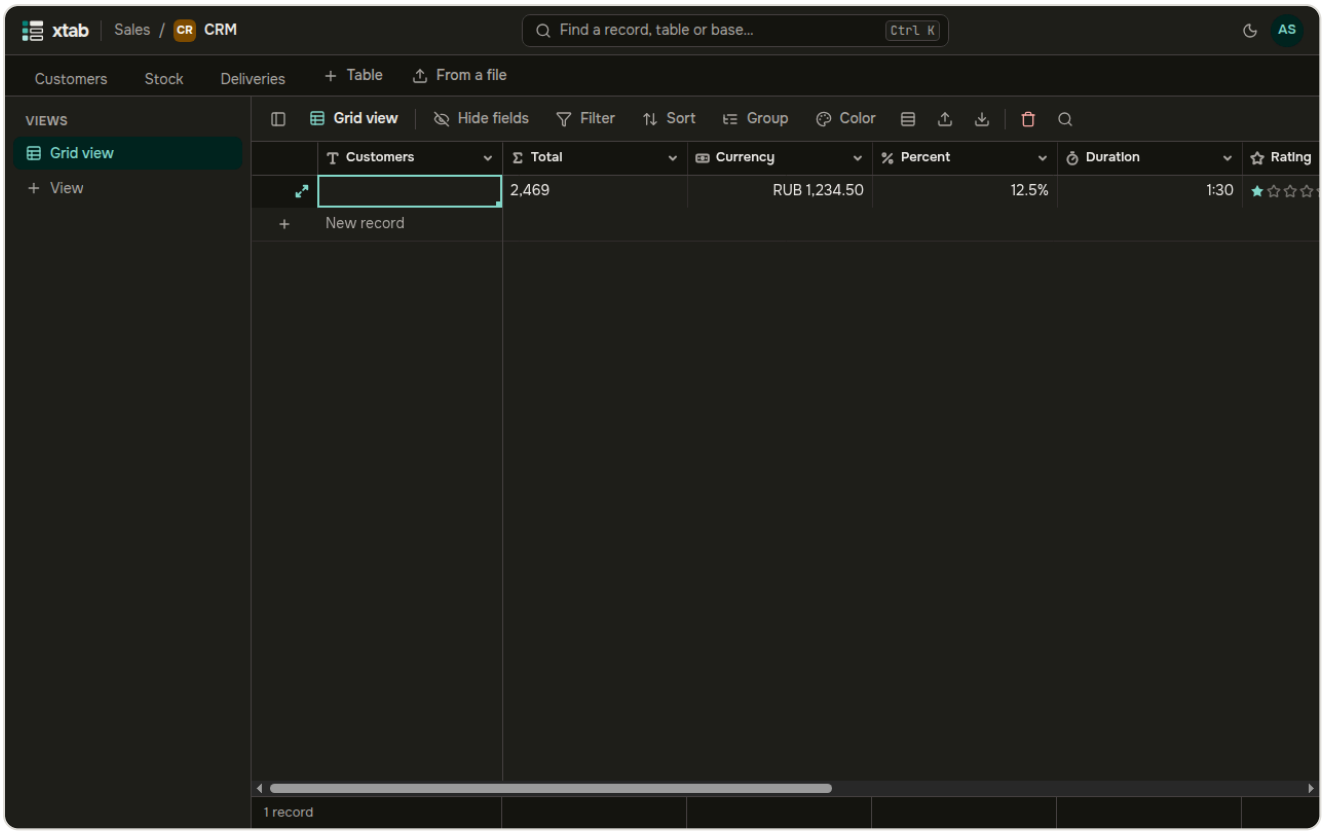
1. While you type a function, the text below the formula shows its arguments and what it does.



A hint on the arguments of a function

1. The line **On the selected record:** shows the result on the current record.
2. Click **Create field**.

A formula recounts by itself when the fields it depends on change. In a big table the recount runs in the background, and the values update as it goes.

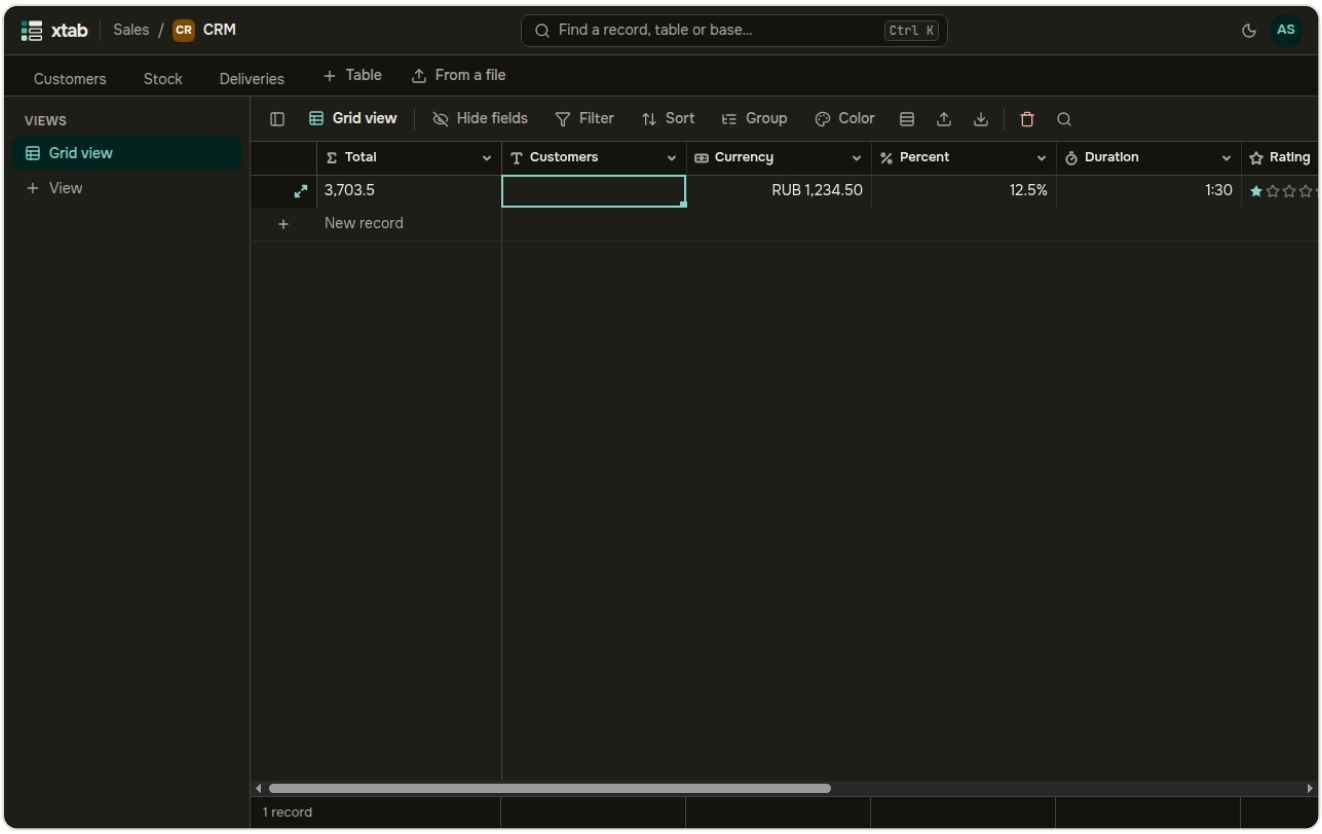


The values of a formula

The functions are the ones you know from Excel and Airtable:

- arithmetic and rounding: `ROUND`, `SUM`, `AVERAGE`;
- conditions: `IF`, `SWITCH`, `AND`, `OR`;
- text: `CONCATENATE`, `LEFT`, `UPPER`, `SUBSTITUTE`;
- dates in the time zone of your organization: `TODAY`, `DATEADD`, `DATETIME_DIFF`, `DATETIME_FORMAT`, `WORKDAY`;
- lists: `ARRAYJOIN`, `ARRAYUNIQUE`;
- regular expressions: `REGEX_MATCH`.

You can filter, sort, group and summarize by the result of a formula. A formula can also be the primary field, so that records are named by its value.

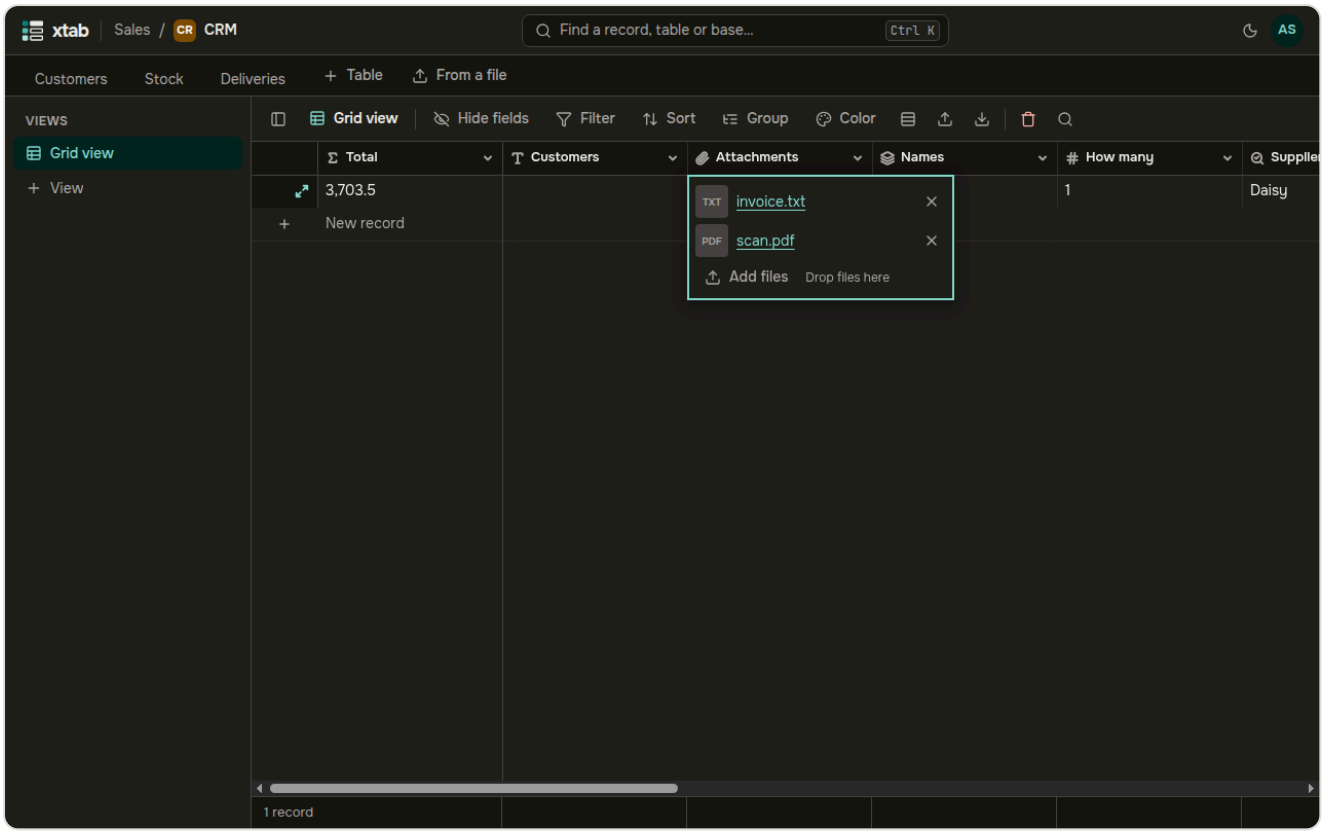


A formula as the primary field

Attachments

An **Attachments** field holds files: contracts, scans, photos.

- **Add files:** select the cell and press Enter, then click **Add files**, or drop the files onto the cell's window. A cell holds up to 100 files.
- **Open a file:** click its name.
- Images, video and sound open in a new tab.
- A PDF opens in a viewer right inside xtab.
- Other files are downloaded.
- **Remove a file:** click the cross to the right of its name. If you removed a file by mistake, undo (Ctrl+Z) and it comes back.



Files in a cell

Images get thumbnails, which show right in the table. When a photo is uploaded, xtab removes the information about where it was taken, the camera and the author.

In the PDF viewer:

- scroll to turn the pages;
- the top bar shows the number of pages and a **Download** button;
- Esc or the cross closes the viewer.

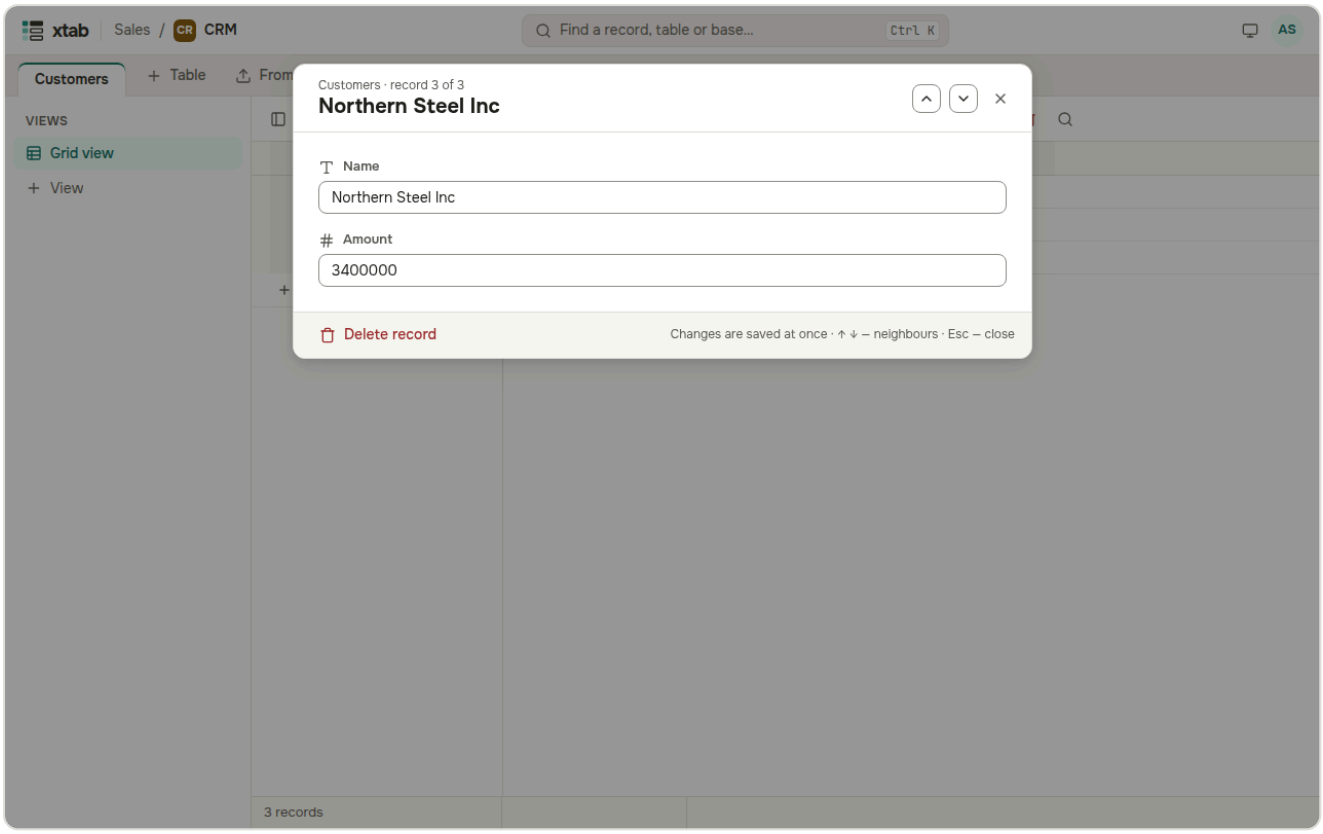
A password-protected document has to be downloaded to open.



The PDF viewer

An expanded record

To see every field of one record at once, select one of its cells and press Space, or click the number of its row on the left.

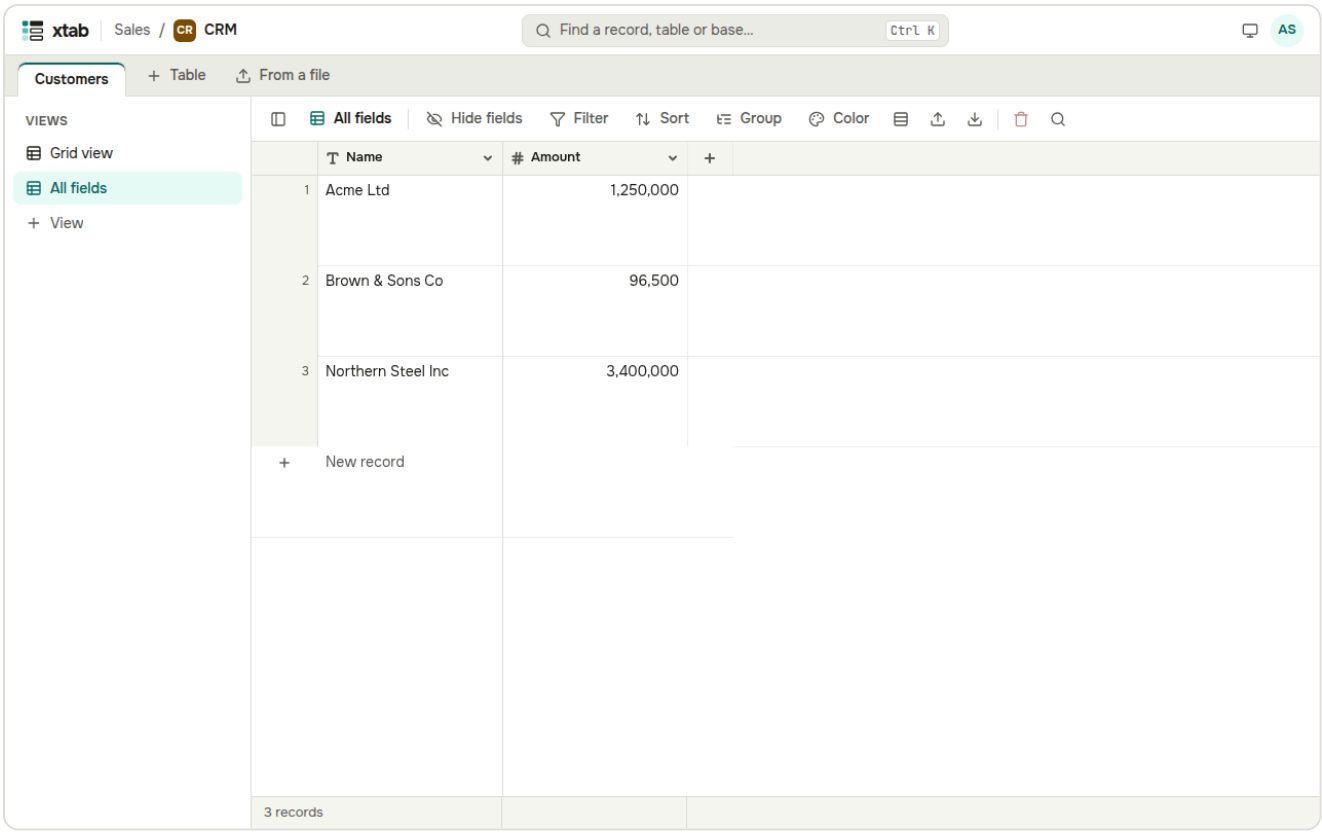


An expanded record

- Change any field: the value is saved as soon as you leave the field or choose an option.
- The arrows ↑ and ↓ (or the buttons at the top) open the neighbouring records.
- Esc or the cross closes the window.

Views

A view is a way of looking at a table: which fields are visible, in what order and how wide the columns are, which records are picked and how they are sorted, grouped and coloured. A table can have many views; they share the data. The list of views is to the left of the table; the panel button at the start of the bar above the table hides and shows it.



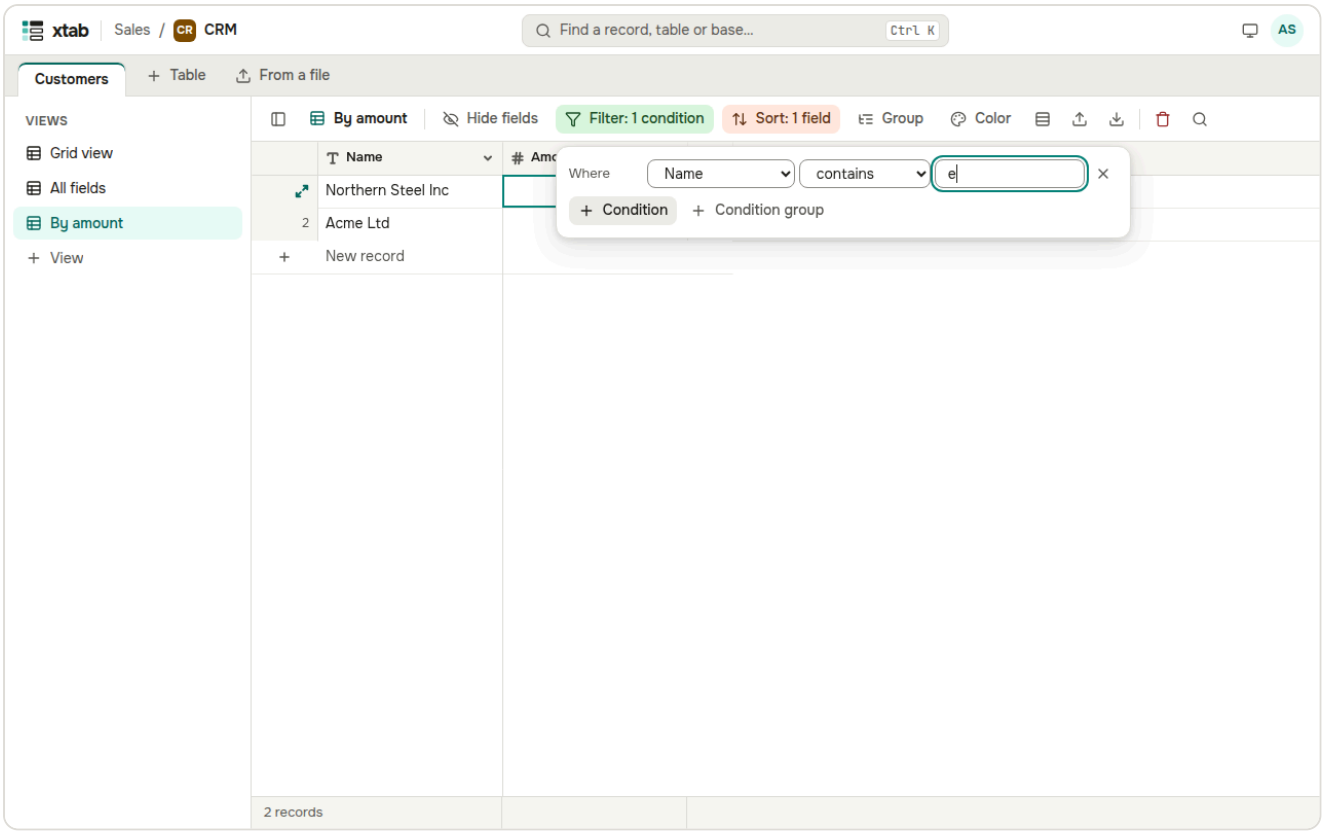
A view with tall rows

- **New view:** click **+ View** in the list on the left, enter a name and press Enter. A new view shows every field.
- **Rename, duplicate, delete:** point at a view in the list and click the pencil, the copy icon or the bin. The last view of a table cannot be deleted.
- **Hide fields:** click **Hide fields** above the table and switch off the fields you do not need; **Hide all** and **Show all** do it at once.
- **Row height:** click the rows icon above the table and choose **Short**, **Medium** or **Tall**.
- **Column width:** drag the right edge of the header of a column.

Every view remembers its own settings. Everyone who opens a view sees it the same way.

Filter

A filter keeps only the matching records in a view. Click **Filter** above the table, then **+ Condition**: choose a field, a condition (for example «contains», «greater than», «today») and a value. Several conditions are joined by «and» or «or»; **+ Condition group** puts conditions in brackets.



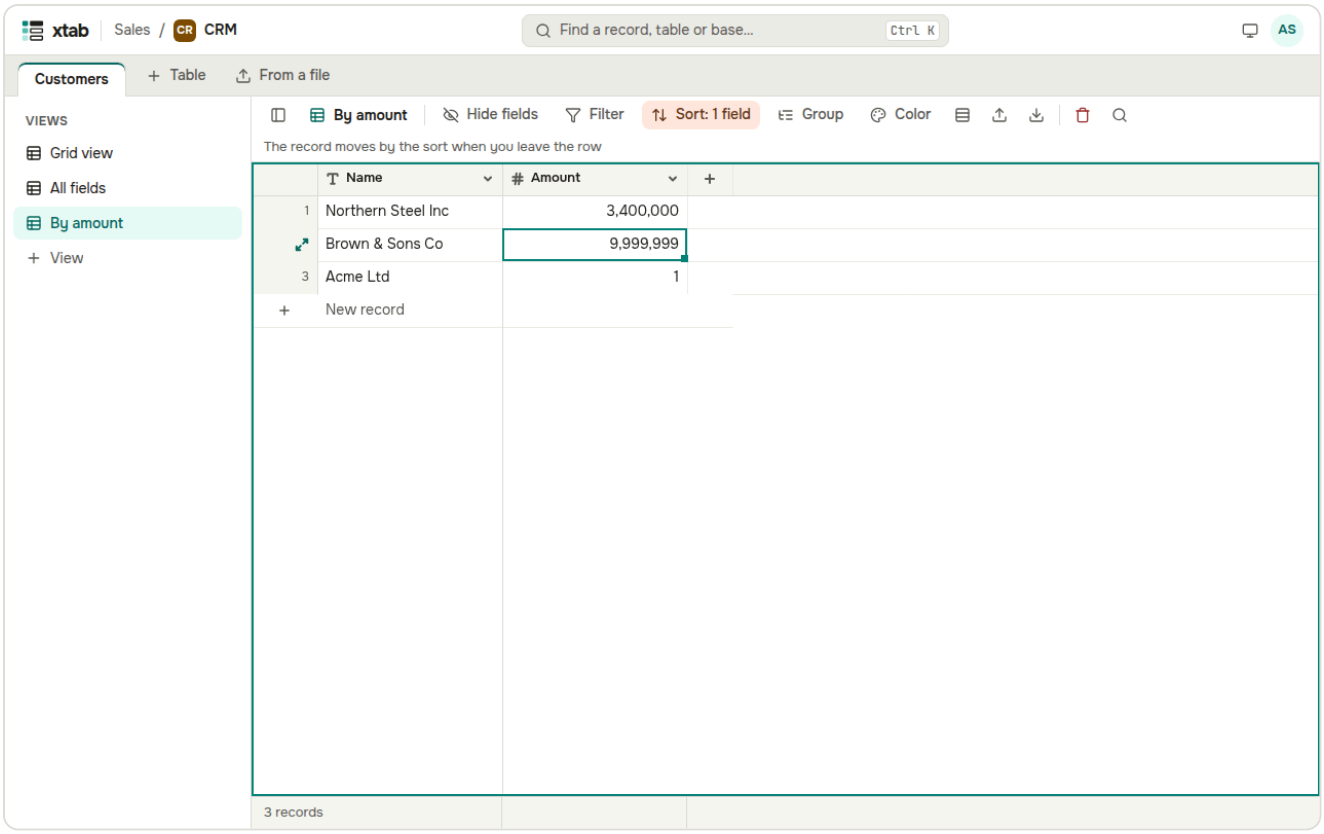
A filter by name

The button lights up and shows the number of conditions. To remove a condition, click the cross to its right.

Sort

Click **Sort** above the table, then **Add sort**, choose a field and a direction. The second and further sorts order the records with equal values of the first one. Without a sort, records come in manual order — the order you added them in.

If you change a value and the record should move by the sort or disappear by the filter, it stays in place until you leave the row; a hint above the table says so.

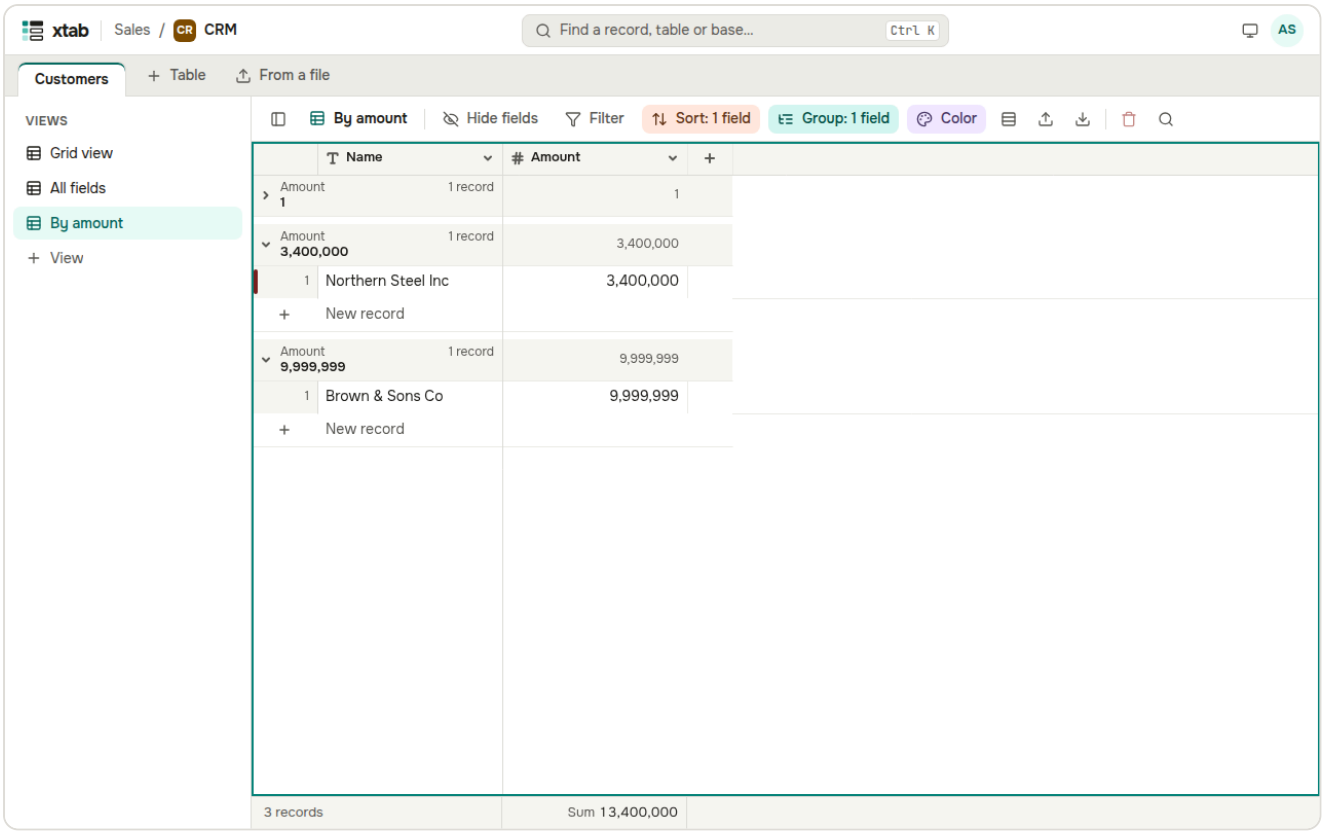


A record stays in place until you leave the row

If you have no right to change the view, you can still set a filter and a sort: only you see them, and they reset when the page reloads. The bar above the table then shows **Temporary filter and sort** with a **Reset** button.

Grouping

Click **Group** above the table, then **Add grouping** and choose a field: records with the same value gather in a group with a header and the number of records. You can group by several fields.



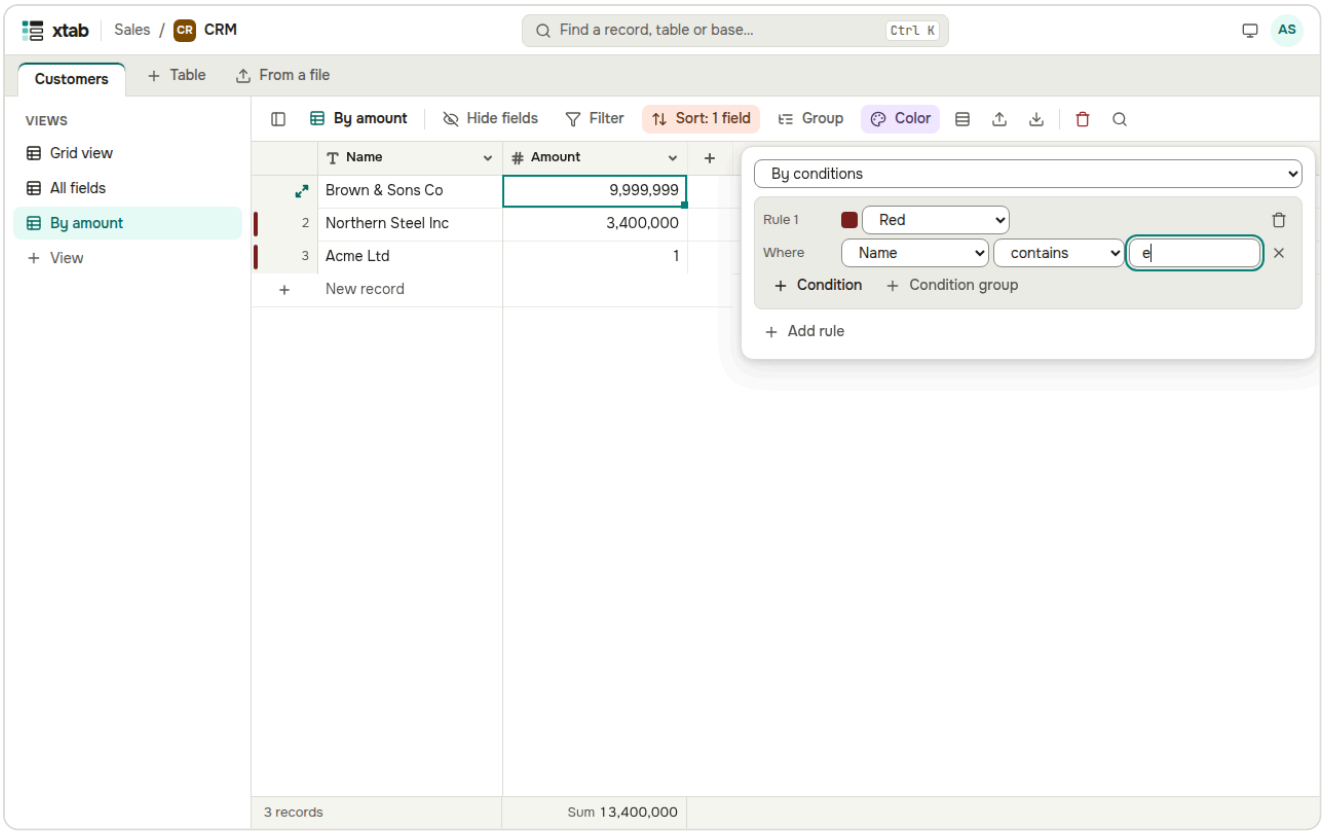
Records grouped by amount

- Click the arrow in the header of a group to collapse or expand it; **Collapse all** and **Expand all** are in the grouping panel.
- The row **New record** at the bottom of a group adds a record with its value already set.

Record colours

Click **Color** above the table and choose how to colour records:

- **By a single select field** — a stripe to the left of a record takes the colour of its option;
- **By conditions** — set a rule: a colour and conditions, as in a filter. **Add rule** adds another one; a record takes the colour of the first rule it meets.



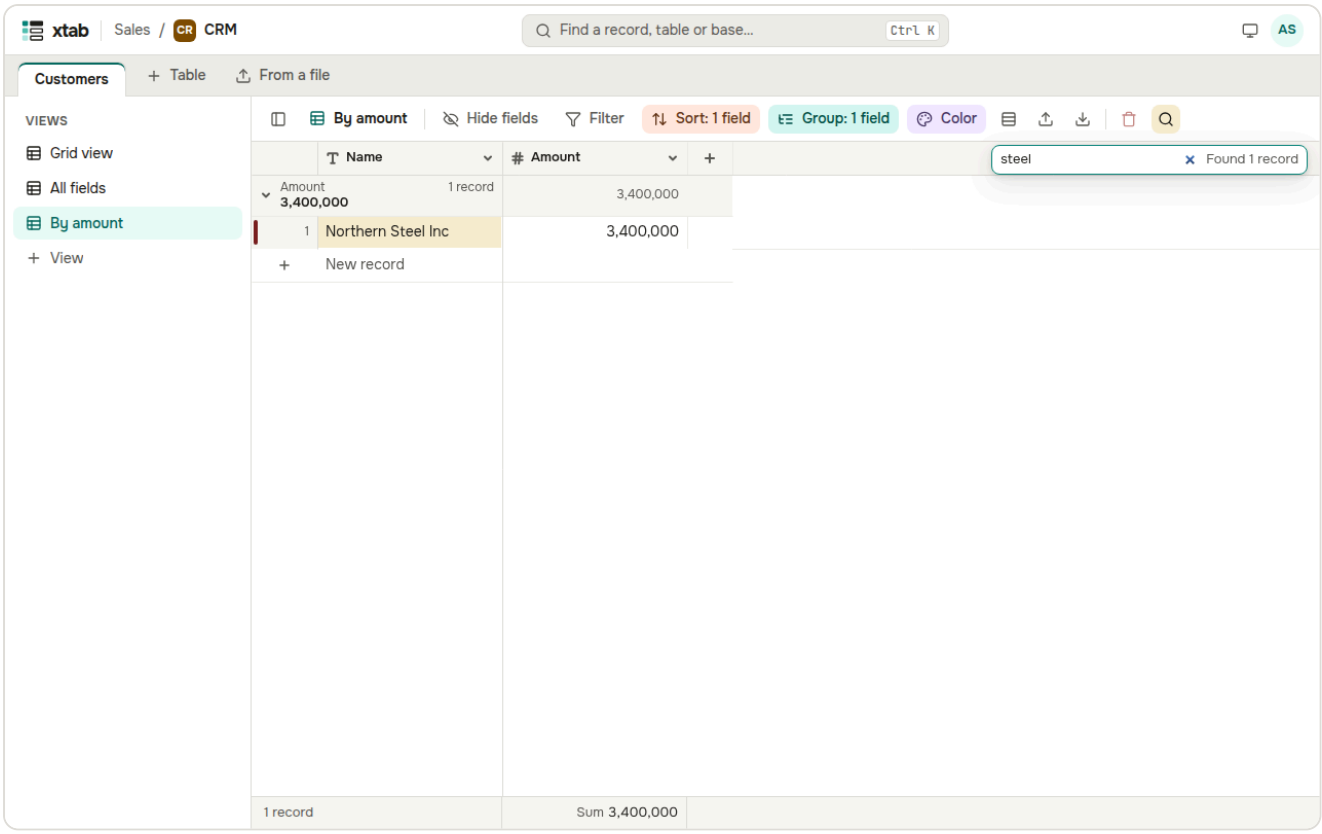
A colour rule

Summaries under columns

In the row at the bottom of the table, click under a column and choose a function: sum, average, minimum, maximum, the number of filled or empty, unique, the earliest or latest date and others. A summary counts the records of the view, with its filter.

Searching a view

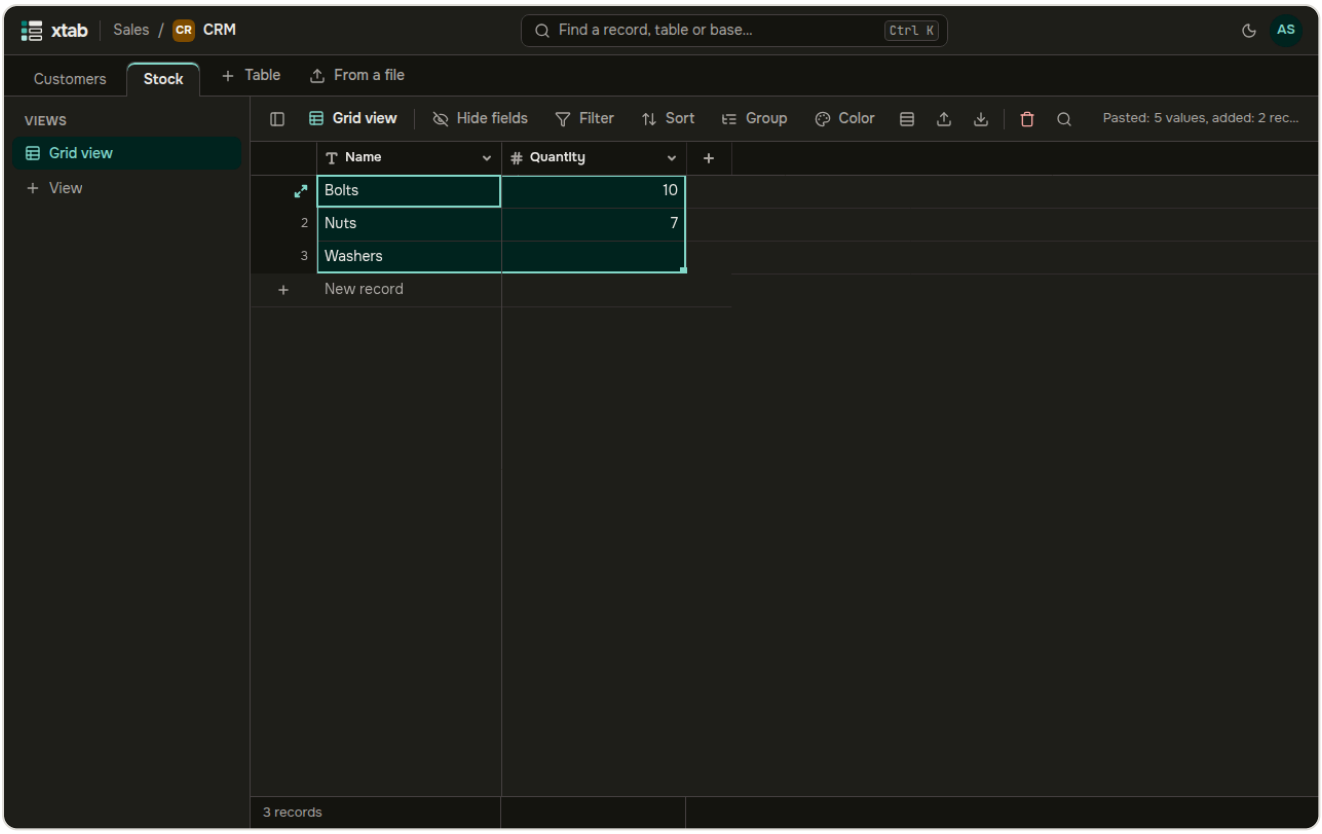
Press Ctrl+F (⌘F on a Mac) or click the magnifier above the table and type the text. The view keeps the records with that text, the matches are highlighted, and the number of records found is shown next to the search box. The cross clears the search.



Searching a view

Selecting, copying and pasting

- **Select a range:** drag the mouse over cells or press the arrows with Shift; Ctrl+A selects every cell of the view.
- **Copy and paste:** Ctrl+C, Ctrl+X and Ctrl+V — also from Excel and Google Sheets and back. If you paste more rows than there are records below, the missing records are added. The bar above the table shows how many values were pasted and which did not fit the fields.
- **Fill down:** drag the small square in the bottom right corner of the selection or press Ctrl+D — the values of the top row are copied down.
- **Clear cells:** Delete.
- **Range menu:** right-click the selection — copy, cut, fill down, clear cells, delete records.



A pasted range

Undo

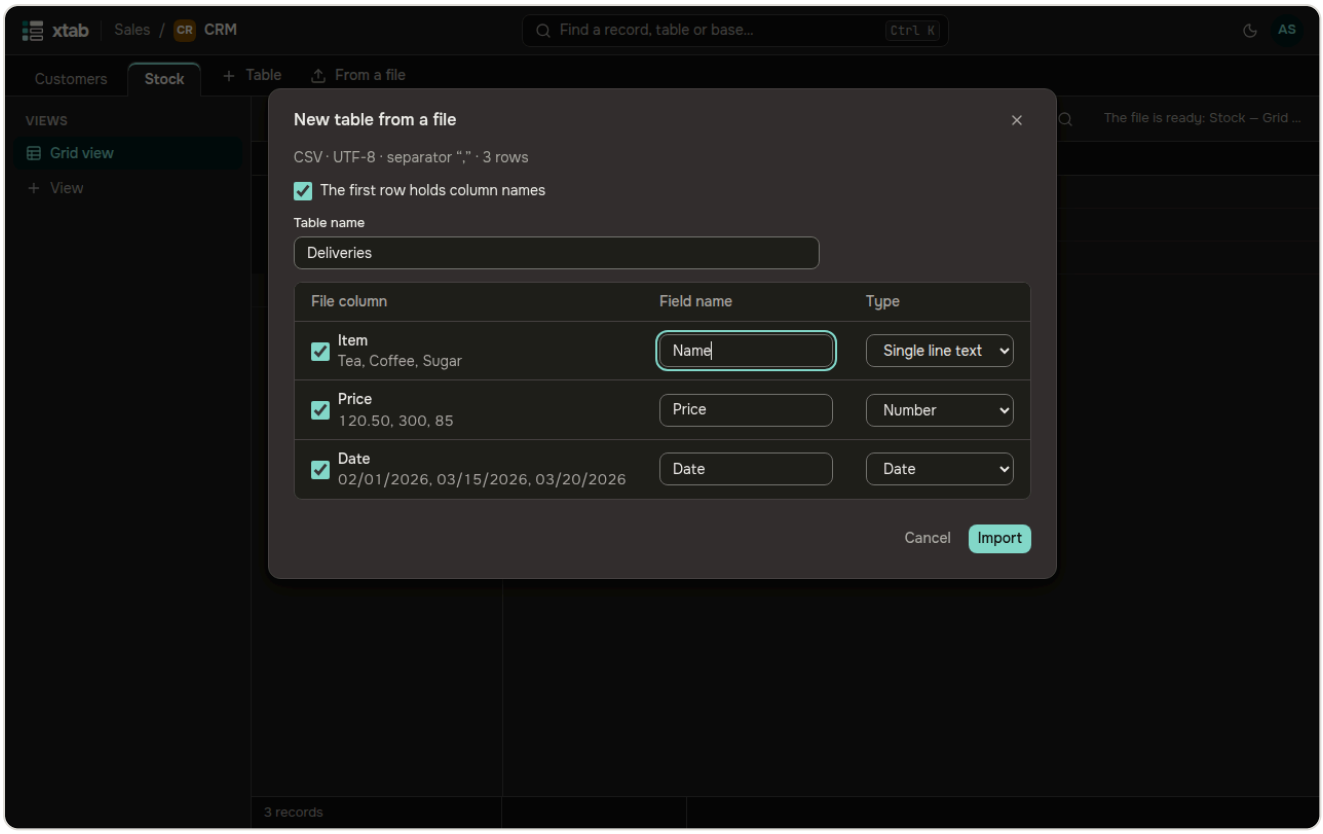
Ctrl+Z undoes the last action in a table: an edit, a paste, clearing, a new or deleted record. Ctrl+Shift+Z or Ctrl+Y redoes it. If another person changed a value after you, their edit is kept.

Import from CSV and Excel

CSV and XLSX files up to 50 MB fit; xtab detects the encoding and separator of CSV itself.

- **New table from a file:** click **From a file** to the right of the table tabs.
- **Records into this table:** click the up-arrow icon above the table.

Drop a file into the window or click **Choose a file**. xtab shows the columns of the file with sample values and suggests a field and a type for each. Clear the checkbox of a column you do not need, correct the names and types and click **Import**.

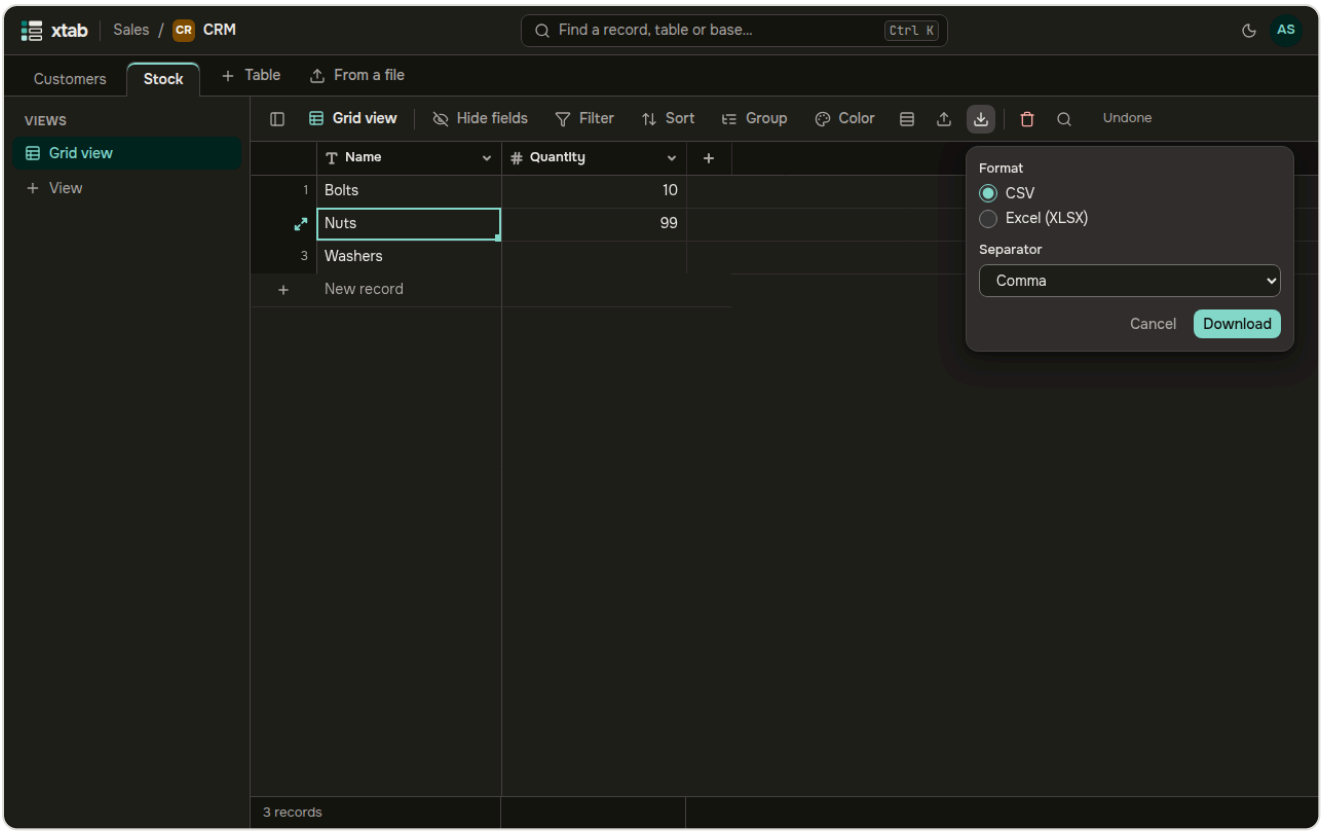


New table from a file

- You may close the window — the import goes on; its progress shows above the table.
- If many values do not fit the fields, the import stops and shows examples: **Import anyway** or **Do not import**. **Download the report** gives a file with every row that did not fit.
- **Delete the imported records** — within a day after the import: removes the records it added. Records changed since then can be kept.

Export to CSV and Excel

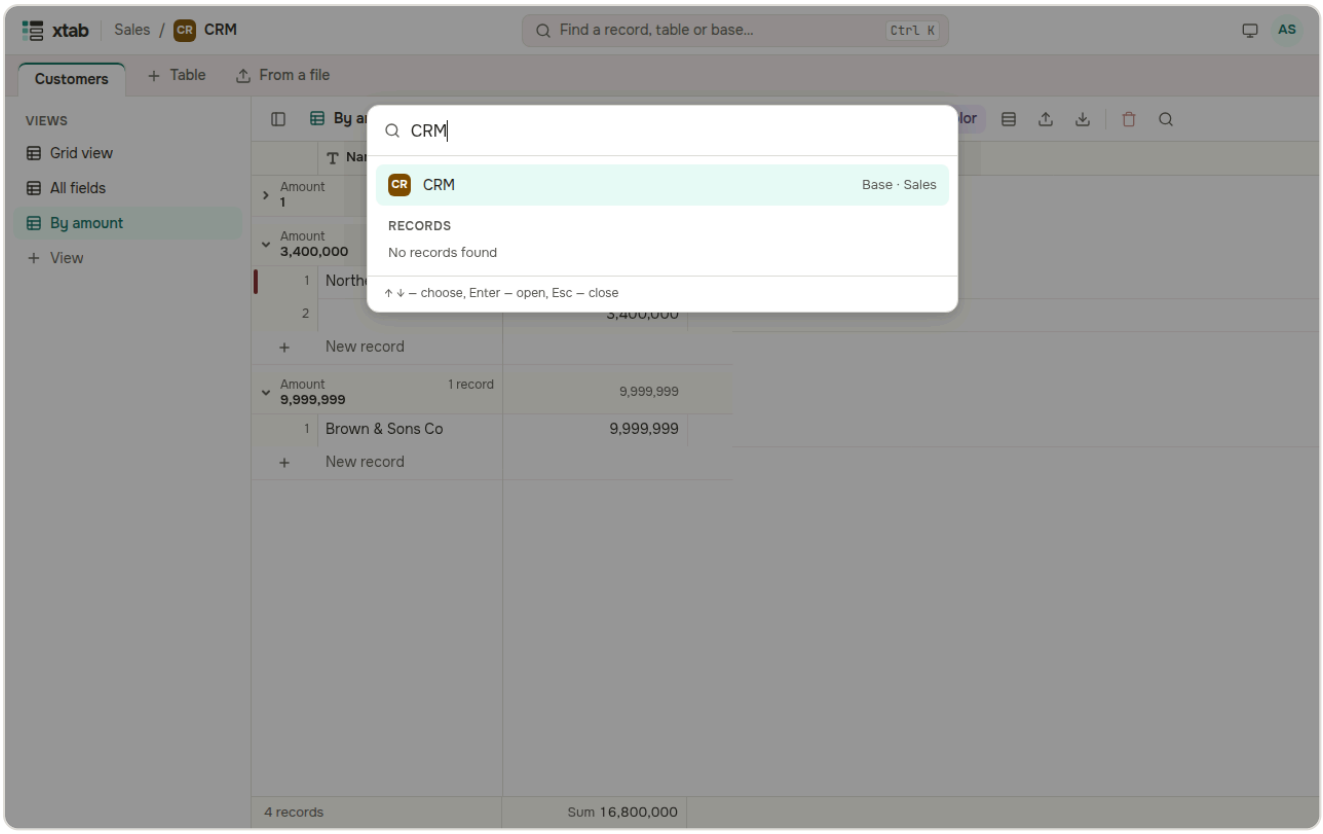
Click the down-arrow icon above the table, choose a format — **CSV** or **Excel (XLSX)** — and for CSV a separator, then **Download**. The file gets the records and fields of the view, with its filter and sort. If there are more than 1000 records, xtab asks for your password again.



Exporting a view

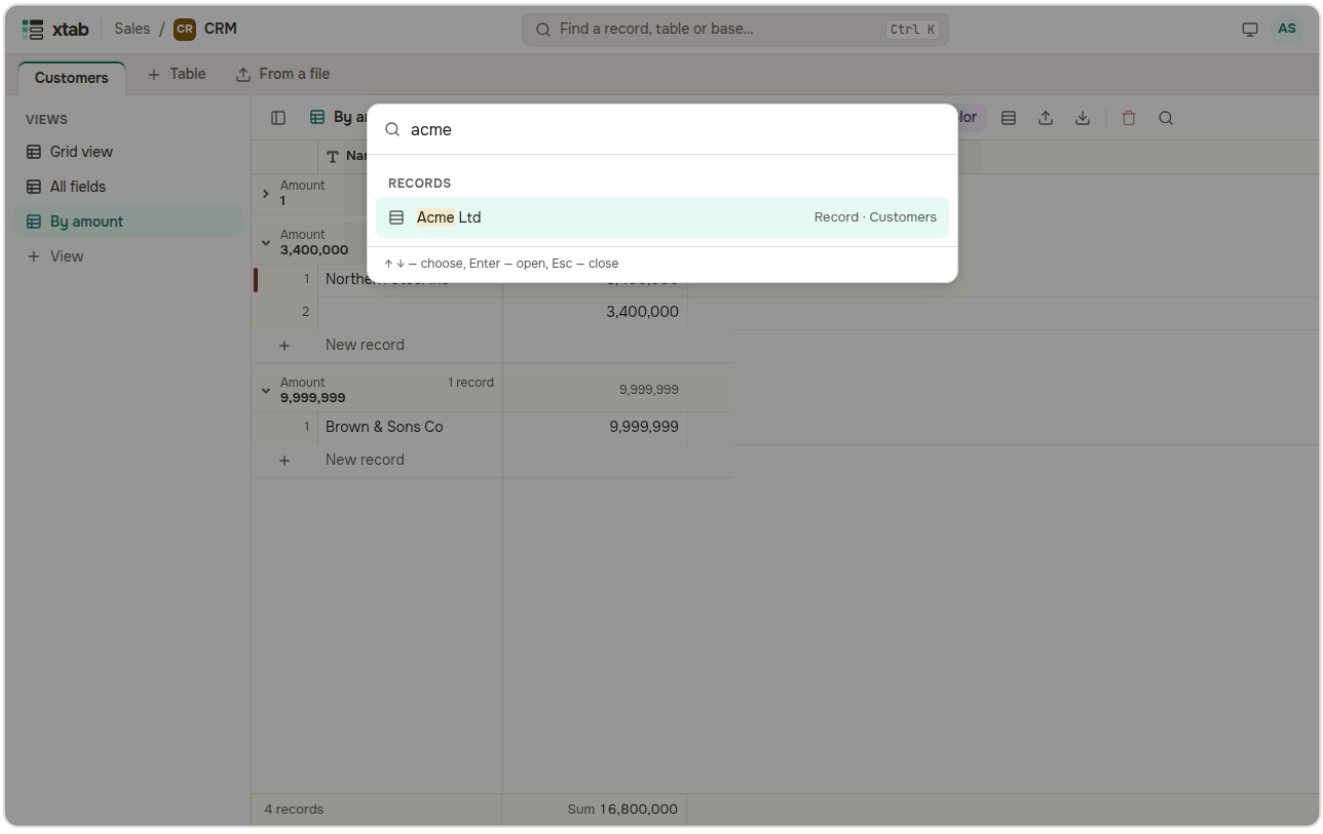
Quick jump

Press Ctrl+K (⌘K on a Mac) or click **Find a record, table or base...** at the top. Start typing the name of a base or a table or the text of a record, choose a result with the arrows and press Enter.



Quick jump

A record found opens expanded in its table.



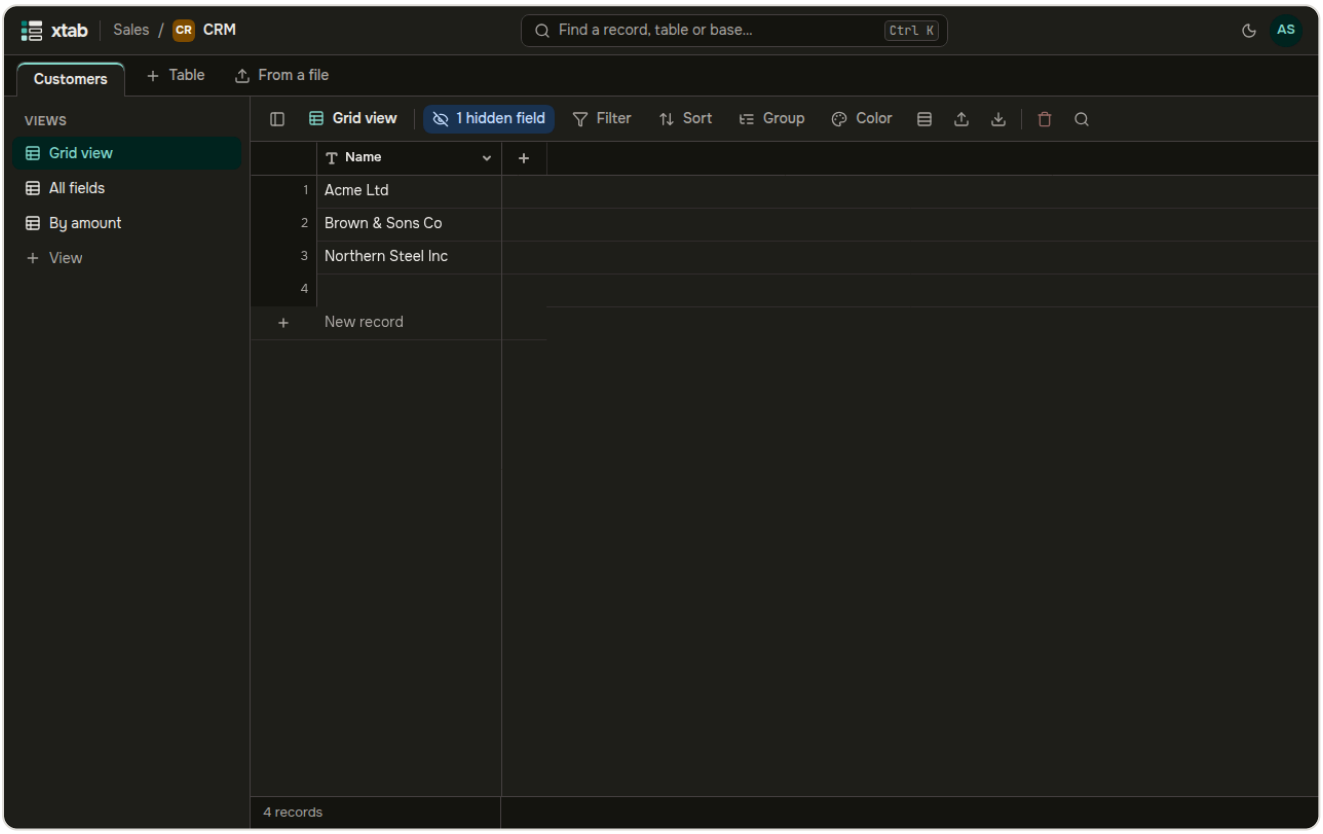
A record in the quick jump

Working together

Changes by other people appear in your table by themselves, without reloading the page: new and deleted records, edits of cells, new fields.

Theme

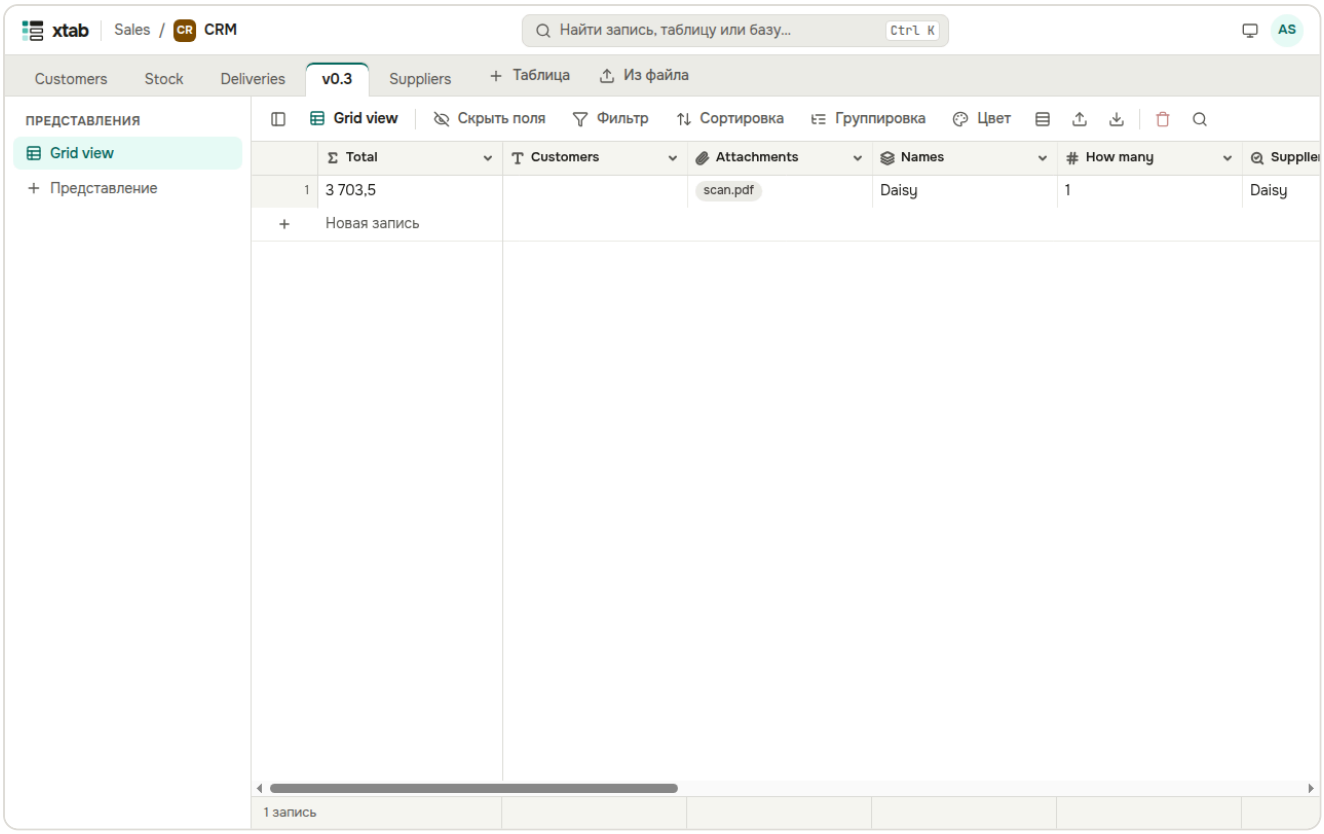
The button to the left of the circle with your initials switches the theme: as in the system, light, dark. The choice is remembered in this browser.



The dark theme

Interface language

xtab speaks Russian and English. By default the language is that of the browser. To choose another, click the circle with your initials and choose **Language: English**, **Language: Русский** or **Language: as in the browser**. The choice is remembered in your account. Numbers and dates in a table are written as the chosen language writes them.



The interface in Russian